RULE BOOK REWRITE

COMPENDIUM

HEROES III
OF MIGHT AND MAGIC®
THE BOARD GAME

The Rewrite

Hermanni Karppela Johannes Wolff
Andrzej Wiącek Alexey Sokolov

October 29, 2026

This is an unreleased version built on GitHub from commit ccfebdb.

This project is licensed under Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike 4.0 International. It is community-driven, and has a GitHub repository. Everyone is welcome to contribute, make changes, and fix errors. You can get in touch with creators through Discord or by writing in the BoardGameGeek thread.

I'm doing this out of the love of learning games and wanting to understand their complexities.
— Hermanni "Heegu" Karppela

Scan to join the community **Discord** server.

Scan to open **GitHub** repository.

Scan to open **BoardGameGeek** thread.

Contents

Introduction **5**

Components **6**

Scenarios **10**
- Scenario Types 10
- Scenario Difficulty 10
- Victory conditions 11

Setup **12**

Round Structure **15**

Player Turns **17**
- Movement Actions 17
- Town Actions 18
- Morale Actions 19

Heroes **20**
- Hero Board Anatomy 21
- Level Effects 21

Deck-building **22**
- General Card Rules 22
- Statistic and Ability Cards 24
- Spell Cards 26
- Hero Specialty Cards 27
- Artifact Cards 27
- Spell Scroll Cards 28
- War Machine Cards 28

Resources **29**

Town **30**

Map Elements **31**
- Placing and Discovering New Tiles 32
- Expansion Tiles 34
- Placing and Discovering Location Tokens 35

Units **36**
- Unit Card Anatomy 37
- Unit Types 38

Combat **40**
- Quick Combat 40
- Combat Setup 41
- Combat Terminology 42
- Combat Round Structure 43
- End of Combat 44
- Siege Combat 46

AI rules **48**
- Combat against AI 48
- AI Heroes 49
- AI Decks 50
- Casting complex Spells 51

Trading **52**

Solo Campaigns **53**

Tournament Mode **54**

Battlefield **56**
- Adventure and Skirmish Setup 57
- Adventure Mode 58
- Skirmish Mode 60
- Battlefield Combat 61
- Battlefield Board in regular games 63

Rule Variants **64**
- Chaos Cards 64
- Neutral Army 64
- Draft Start 64
- Split Artifact and Spell Decks 65
- Gold Pool 65
- Creature Banks 66
- Alternative Combat Boards 67
- Optional Rules Table 68

Expansion Content **69**
- Faction Expansions 70
- Gameplay and Game Mode Expansions 71
- Stretch Goal Content 71

All Map Locations **73**
- Symbols on the Map 73
- Towns 76
- Mines 76
- Settlements 77
- Revisitable Fields 78
- Other Fields 79
- Location Tokens 82

Card Effect Keywords **86**
- Spell Card Keywords 86
- Summoning 88
- Tokens on Units 89
- Fan-Made Wiki 89

Credits **90**

Index **91**

The continent of Antagarich is at war as several different Factions, led by their Heroes, battle for supremacy. Choose your Faction and Hero and banish your unruly enemies from these lands!

Castle: Human armies rallied under the banners of Clerics and Knights, bolstered by the might of Griffins and protected by Angels.

Dungeon: Subterranean forces led by Warlocks and Overlords, wielding dark magic and bending fearsome creatures to their will.

Necropolis: Legions of the undead, commanded by Necromancers and Death Knights, who sap the strength of the living to fuel their own.

More Factions, Heroes, and their armies await in the expansions.

INTRODUCTION

Heroes of Might and Magic III: The Board Game is a tactical strategy RPG board game for 1–3 players using the core box set, or more when using expansions.

Notice: In this rule book, game and component terms are Capitalized. **Bold text** is used to draw attention to important rules. *Italicization* is used for gameplay examples. Brown colored hyperlinks (p. 5) will take you to other parts of the rule book. Names of specific cards have a ° appended to them, e.g., Magic Arrow°; you can find further information about them in the Game Wiki (p. 89). Expansion Content (p. 69) from different expansions is marked with colored bars on the left margin:

TOWER EXPANSION

RAMPART EXPANSION

FORTRESS EXPANSION

INFERNO EXPANSION

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

CONFLUX EXPANSION

COVE EXPANSION

BATTLEFIELD EXPANSION

NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

STRETCH GOALS 2 EXPANSION

Exceptions and notes with amber colored hyperlinks (p. 5) are explained in boxes like this one.

Conflicting rule changes on components follow this priority: Player Cards, Unit Cards, Town Boards, Mission Book, this rule book.

Images with map locations from expansions are marked with a label below them:

Mine: Sawmill

RAMPART EXPANSION

COMPONENTS

This guide provides a visual overview of all components included in every expansion. For detailed information, including exact quantities and images of each individual component, please refer to the Archon's official content guide.

Map Tile (p. 31)

COVE EXPANSION

Sea Map Tile (p. 34)

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

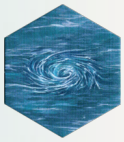
Subterranean Map Tile (p. 34)

Movement Tokens (p. 17)

NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

Creature Bank Token (p. 35)

COVE EXPANSION



Whirlpool Token (p. 35)

CONFLUX EXPANSION

Monolith Token (p. 35)

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

Subterranean Gate (p. 35)

Town Board (p. 30)

Building Tiles (p. 30)

STRETCH GOALS 2 EXPANSION

Town card (p. 72)

Gold Tokens (p. 29)

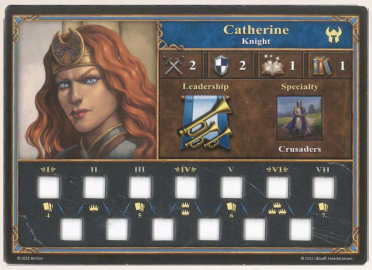
Building Materials (p. 29)

Valuables Token (p. 29)

Build Token (p. 18)

Population Token (p. 18)

Spell Book Token (p. 18)



Hero Board (p. 21)

Hero Miniatures

Astrologers Proclaim card (p. 15)

FORTRESS EXPANSION

Event card (p. 15)

BATTLEFIELD EXPANSION

Adventure card (p. 59)

STRETCH GOALS 2 EXPANSION

Pandora's Box card (p. 72)

Faction Cubes

Black Cubes

Grail Token (p. 79)

NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

Empowered Ability Token (p. 25)

STRETCH GOALS 2 EXPANSION

Expert Effect Markers (p. 21)

Round Tracker (p. 15)

Attack Dice (p. 42)

Treasure Dice (p. 73)

Resource Dice (p. 29)

Unit Miniatures (p. 69)
(Not included in the core game)

Spell card (p. 26)

Artifact card (p. 27)

Ability card (p. 24)

Statistic card (p. 24)

Hero Specialty card (p. 27)

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

Spell Scroll card (p. 28)

NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

Empowered Ability card (p. 24)

INFERNO EXPANSION

Empowered Statistic card (p. 24)

Faction Unit card (p. 36)

CONFLUX EXPANSION

Summoned Unit card (p. 88)

NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

Creature Bank Unit card (p. 66)

RAMPART EXPANSION
COVE EXPANSION

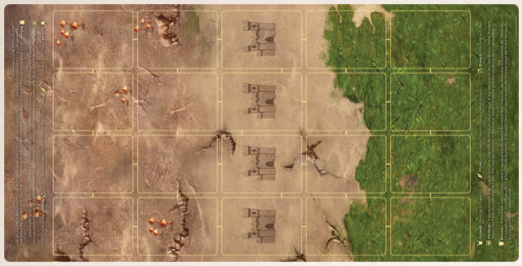
War Machine card (p. 28)

Neutral Unit card (p. 38)

Arrow Tower card (p. 46)

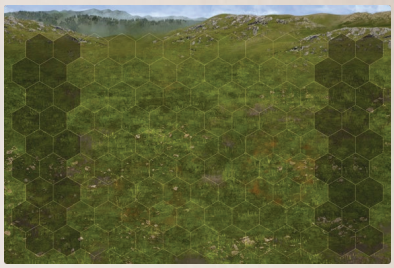
Gate, Walls cards (p. 46)

AI card (p. 50)



Combat Board (p. 40)

BATTLEFIELD EXPANSION



Battlefield Board (p. 61)

Paralysis/ Defense Token (p. 42)

Damage Token (p. 43)

NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

Stack Tokens (p. 67)

COVE EXPANSION

Weakness Token (p. 89)

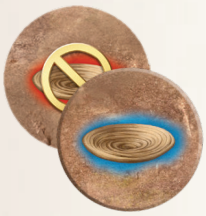
STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

Attack Token (p. 89)

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

Corrosion Token (p. 89)

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION



Quicksand Tokens (p. 87)

COVE EXPANSION

Clone Tokens (p. 86)

STRETCH GOALS 2 EXPANSION

Land Mine Tokens (p. 87)

STRETCH GOALS 2 EXPANSION

Force Field Token (p. 87)

BATTLEFIELD EXPANSION

Negative Morale card (p. 19)

BATTLEFIELD EXPANSION

Positive Morale card (p. 19)

CONFLUX EXPANSION

Summon Tokens (p. 88)

CONFLUX EXPANSION
COVE EXPANSION
STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

Time Token (p. 22)

Morale Token (p. 19)

CONFLUX EXPANSION

Luna's Fire Wall Token (p. 87)

BATTLEFIELD EXPANSION

Battlefield Obstacles (p. 61)

BATTLEFIELD EXPANSION

Initiative Token (p. 61)

SCENARIOS

Heroes III is a Scenario-driven game. In the first step of each game's setup, you choose a **Scenario** from the Mission Book. Scenarios have a backstory and determine the map layout, the starting conditions for players, and the requirements for winning the Scenario. Furthermore, Scenarios can introduce entirely unique game rules.

Scenario Types

Clash

A fully competitive mode. Your opponents control Neutral Units in your Combat.

Campaign

A single-player mode of interconnected Scenarios against an enemy AI. For rules unique to Solo Mode, see the Campaign rules (p. 53). Further rule changes are detailed in the Campaign Mission Books.

Alliance

Usually a 2 vs. 2 team-based mode with expanded opportunities to trade (p. 52) between allied players.

Cooperative

A Cooperative mode where everyone shares the same goal. The AI rules (p. 48) and expanded Trading rules (p. 52) apply here.

Tournament

A 1 vs. 1 mode with a different way of building the Map and scoring. See Tournament Mode (p. 54).

BATTLEFIELD EXPANSION

Battlefield Expansion (p. 56) introduces two focused 1 vs. 1 game modes **which work without Scenarios**.

Adventure

The Map exploration is replaced with Adventure cards, culminating in a tactical combat on a large hexagonal battlefield, see Adventure Mode (p. 58) for details.

Skirmish

Skip the exploration phase and engage directly in tactical combat, see Skirmish Mode (p. 60) for details.

Scenario Difficulty

You can modify the Difficulty of a Scenario. There are four different Difficulties, each with a different starting bonus that you receive during step 17 of the setup (p. 13):

- **Easy** – Roll 2 Resource Dice ⚒ and receive Resources from both – OR – **Search** (2) the Artifact Deck, twice.
- **Normal** – Roll 2 Resource Dice ⚒ and receive the Resources from one of them – OR – **Search** (2) the Artifact Deck.
- **Hard** – Roll 1 Resource Die ⚒ and receive the Resources on it – OR – reveal cards from the top of the Artifact Deck until you find 1 Minor Artifact and add it to your hand.
- **Impossible** – No starting bonus.

Campaign Scenarios have unique bonuses that **replace** the regular starting bonus.

Searching **Artifacts** (p. 22) is explained in the general card rules. Artifacts received from a starting bonus must be placed into

your **hand** and not shuffled into your Starting Deck. If you searched for any Artifacts, shuffle the Artifact Deck and its Discard Pile together afterwards, and then discard one Artifact from the top to form the Artifact Discard Pile again.

The chosen Difficulty also determines the number and type of Neutral Units that are encountered during Neutral Combat according to the table on the back cover of the book.

Victory conditions

All Scenarios have their victory conditions described in the Mission Book. The most common victory conditions require defeating certain enemy Towns, Heroes, or Neutral Units; capturing the Grail; or controlling certain or most Locations over time. Whenever a player achieves a victory condition, the game ends at the end of the Round, unless stated otherwise.

In addition, it is always possible to be **eliminated** from any Scenario in the following ways:

- Play 3 full Rounds without controlling a Town or a Settlement. Count the number of Rounds left using any suitable component.
- Lose Combat with your **Main Hero** when you have no Towns or Settlements left, including when defending your last Town or Settlement.

Eliminated players are immediately removed from the game. Discard their Faction Cubes and Hero models from the Map. Treat the cards in their Deck as being removed from the game for the rest of the Scenario. If you are eliminated, you may still participate in the game by controlling Neutral Units.

> If you eliminate all enemy Factions, you immediately win the Scenario.

In **Clash** Scenarios with three or more players, when you collect **a Faction Cube** from every enemy player, you win the Scenario. You gain such Faction Cubes by defeating enemy Heroes or conquering enemy Towns. Other Scenario-specific rules may also modify the outcome of collecting Faction Cubes.

After finishing a **Solo Campaign** Scenario, see the Campaign section (p. 53) for how to prepare for the next Scenario of the Campaign.

SETUP

This section will guide you through the process of setting up a Scenario from the Mission Book.

1. Select a Scenario from the Mission Book. For your first game, we recommend choosing the "Brave New World" Scenario (see page 7 in the Mission Book).
2. Choose your Faction from those available.
3. Choose one of your Faction's Heroes as your Main Hero. Each Faction has at least one double-sided Hero Board, with each side depicting a different Hero.
4. Take the following components belonging to your Faction:
   a) 1 × Double-sided Hero Board (on the side of the chosen Hero)
   b) 2 × Hero model
   c) 7 × Town Building Tile
   d) 1 × Town Board
   e) 7 × Double-sided unit card
   f) 3 × Hero-specific Specialty card (of the chosen Hero)
   g) 1 × Hero-specific Ability card (of the chosen Hero)
   h) 20 × Faction Cube
   i) 1 × Build Token
   j) 1 × Population Token
   k) 1 × Spell Book Token
   l) 3 × Movement Tokens
5. Place one of your Faction Cubes on the first space of the Level Tracker found on the Hero Board (Represented by I). Your Hero is now Level I.
6. Set up the Map Tiles and other Scenario-specific components as shown in the Mission Book.
7. Place the Town Board of your chosen Faction in front of you and set the Town Building Tiles next to it. Check which Buildings are already built in the Scenario you are about to play, and place the respective Building Tiles on the Town Board. Resolve any immediate effects from already built Buildings at the end of the setup.
8. Set your starting income as indicated by the Scenario by placing your Faction Cubes on the income trackers on your Town Board. Place the Population, Build, and Spell Book Tokens in their respective slots on the Town Board.
9. Group the Resource Tokens into separate piles located within reach of all players. Take the starting Resources determined by the Scenario you are playing and place them next to your Town Board. This is your Resource pool.
10. Separate the remaining Tokens into their respective piles.
11. Sort the Statistic cards into four piles: Attack,° Defense,° Power,° and Knowledge.° Refer to the Statistics on your Hero Board (p. 21) and take the corresponding number of cards from each pile.
12. If your Main Hero is a Hero of Might, add 1 copy of the Magic Arrow° Spell to your Deck, and if they're a Hero of Magic, add 2 of these Spells to your Deck.

13. Add your Hero's Ability (p. 24) and Level I Specialty (p. 27) cards to your Starting Deck.
14. Shuffle your Starting Deck and place it face down next to your Hero Board. This Deck is your Main Hero's **Deck of Might & Magic**, and is now ready. In this rule book, this is shortened to **your Deck**.
15. Sort the Ability, Artifact, and Spell cards into 3 face down Decks (including any unused Magic Arrow Spells) and shuffle them.
16. From each of these 3 Decks, take the top card and place it face up next to its Deck, creating 3 separate Discard Piles.
17. Choose the Scenario's Difficulty (p. 10) and take the corresponding Starting Bonus(es).
18. Sort the Neutral Units into 4 Decks according to their tier (★☆☆★). Shuffle these Decks and leave enough room for their Discard Piles.
19. Place the Combat Board within reach of the players. Check the Scenario for which starting units you receive and place them into a pile near your Town Board, separate from the rest of your Faction's units.
20. Place the Round Tracker next to the game map and place a Black Cube on the "1" space.
21. Shuffle the Astrologers Proclaim cards and place them face down next to the Round Tracker.
22. Orientate your Starting Tile to your liking. Choose which Hero model represents your Main Hero in this game and place the chosen model on the center Field of your Starting Tile.
23. Choose a starting player. The starting player never changes during the game.

If you're playing with expansions, additionally do the following:

FORTRESS EXPANSION

24. Shuffle the Event cards (p. 15) and place them face down next to the Round Tracker.

NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

25. Group Stack Tokens, Far- and Near Creature Bank Tokens into separate piles and shuffle them. Place Creature Bank unit cards (p. 66) near Neutral Unit Decks.

CONFLUX EXPANSION

26. Place Summoned Elemental Unit cards (p. 88) face up near Neutral Unit Decks.

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

27. Shuffle 10 Spell Scroll cards (p. 28) into the Artifact Deck. Place the remaining 10 in a separate pile.

INFERNO EXPANSION

28. Place the Empowered Statistic cards (p. 24) face up in a separate pile.

NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

29. Place the Empowered Ability cards (p. 24) face up next to the Ability Deck.

STRETCH GOALS 2 EXPANSION

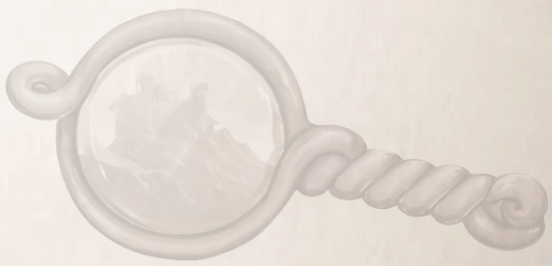
30. Shuffle Pandora's Box cards (p. 72).

BATTLEFIELD EXPANSION

31. Shuffle Morale cards (p. 19).

RAMPART EXPANSION

32. Place the War Machine cards (p. 28) face up in a separate pile.



C Core game

E Expansions

ROUND STRUCTURE

The game is structured into Rounds, during which each player will take their own Turn in a clockwise order starting with the starting player. During their Turns, players will move their Heroes (p. 20) on the Game Map, construct new Buildings in their Town (p. 30), and recruit units (p. 36) in an attempt to fulfill the Scenario's victory condition.

Perform the following steps **at the start of every Round** except the first one:

- Flip any previously used Build, Population and/or Spell Book Tokens back to their active side.
- Flip any previously used Movement Point (MP) Tokens back to their active, green side.
- Regain uses for Expert Effects (p. 24).

Then, depending on the current Round number, players either gain Resources or resolve an Astrologers Proclaim card:

- Odd-numbered Rounds except the first one are **Resource Rounds**, in which:
  - ▷ All players gain income from the Buildings, Settlements, and Mines (p. 76) they control.

  FORTRESS EXPANSION
  - ▷ Players draw next Event, see to the right.
- Even-numbered Rounds are **Astrologers' Rounds**. Draw an Astrologers Proclaim card and resolve its effects.
- If the Scenario has timed Events marked on the Round Tracker that have now been reached, resolve them.

FORTRESS EXPANSION

Events

Event cards may be used in multiplayer games only. Shuffle the Event Deck during setup. At the start of each Resource Round, draw and read the next Event card after receiving Resources. The starting player draws first. **Change the player who draws the Event clockwise** every time a new Event is drawn. Resolve any effects in clockwise order starting with the drawer. Cards revealed as a part of resolving an Event are shuffled back into their respective Decks.

Event card

Astrologers Proclaim card

1. Name
2. Flavor text
3. Effect

Turn Order

After the start of the Round, players take Turns in a clockwise order as described in the next section. After all players have played their Turn, move the Black Cube on the Round Tracker one space forward and perform the start of Round again. Keep playing new Rounds until any of the Scenario's ending conditions have been met.

In the **Alliance game**, teams take turns alternately. At the start of your team's first turn of the Round, choose who goes first and last in that Round.

Example Round

Alice is playing as the Tower Faction against Bob playing as the Dungeon Faction. Alice is the starting player. They are about to start the 5th Round.

Before anything else, both players flip their Build, Population, and Spell Book Tokens back to their active side. All Movement Tokens are flipped back to their active, green sides. Both players also regain the use of their Expert Effects.

Round 5 is an odd-numbered Round, and not the first, so it is a ***Resource Round****. Both players collect income from their Buildings, Mines, and Settlements.*

Since both Alice and Bob have City Halls built, they resolve their "At the beginning of each Resource Round" effects. The Tower City Hall° allows Alice to either gain 4 or draw a card from her Deck. She chooses the latter. The Dungeon City Hall° gives Bob the option to gain extra 5 or 1. Bob chooses the former.

FORTRESS EXPANSION

Since this is a Resource Round, an Event card should now be drawn from the Event Deck. The drawing responsibility rotates clockwise after each Event: Alice, as the starting player, drew the first Event back in Round 3.

FORTRESS EXPANSION

It is therefore Bob's turn to draw. He takes the top card from the Event Deck, reads it aloud, and places it face-up so both players can see: it is ***Artifact Merchant*** *(see the Event card on the previous page).*

Bob draws 5 cards from the top of the Artifact Deck, revealing them to both players. Among them there is a Major Artifact – the Head of Legion.° Bob goes first, as the player who drew the Event. He immediately purchases the Head of Legion, pays 5 (putting the gold from the City Hall to good use) and adds it to his hand. He passes the remaining cards to Alice. Alice had also wanted the Head of Legion, but it is already gone. She is not interested in the remaining cards, therefore she passes. Since the cards have now returned to the player who drew them, the Event ends. The remaining Artifacts are shuffled back into the Artifact Deck.

Round 5 also has a timed Event marked on the Round Tracker: Scenario specifies that all Heroes gain +1 this Round. Bob controls only his Main Hero, so only one extra MP is added, increasing their from 3 to 4. Because Alice controls both a Main Hero and a Secondary Hero, ***both*** *of them benefit – their movement goes to 4 and 3, respectively.*

As a starting player, Alice now starts her Turn.

PLAYER TURNS

At the start of your Turn, refresh your hand of cards following these steps:

- Discard any number of cards from your hand. If your current hand exceeds your Hand Limit, you must discard down to match the Limit.
- You may then draw cards up to your Hand Limit.
- Resolve any "at the beginning of your turn" abilities after drawing.

Your current Hand Limit depends on your Main Hero's Level (p. 21). The beginning of your Turn is the only time your Hand Limit is checked.

There are three types of Actions players may take: **Movement**, **Town**, and **Morale**. Once all players have spent all their Movement Points and do not wish to use any further Town or Morale Actions, the current Round is over.

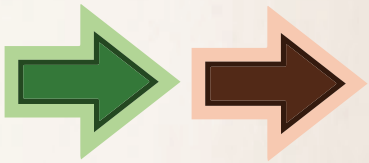
Whenever you are instructed to gain (additional) MP, sometimes represented by the symbol, that MP persists for **only the Turn it was gained on**. In the unlikely situation that two allied Heroes are forced onto the same Field, you must use your next MP to move one of them away from that Field.

Movement Actions

Movement Actions are performed by spending Movement Points. A player can use Movement Actions **only during their own Turn**.

For every 1 MP spent, you can perform one of the following Actions:

- Move a Hero 1 Field in any direction.
- Revisit (p. 32) a Field where your Hero is in.
- Continue Combat (p. 43) against Neutral Units for 1 additional Combat Round.
- Discover a face down Map Tile (p. 32) if your Hero is on a Field next to that Tile.
- Place a new Map Tile from your pool of Far (II–III) Map Tiles.



An active and an inactive Movement Token.

Mark the amount of MP you have used by flipping your Movement Tokens over to their brown, inactive side. If a player has both a Main and a Secondary Hero (p. 20), track their MPs separately. Heroes can spend MP in any order.

Allied Heroes can move through each other but cannot stop their movement in the same Field. When you move through a Field with an allied Hero, do not visit (p. 32) the Field that the allied Hero is standing on.

Town Actions

You can perform each of the Town Actions listed below **once per Round**. These Actions can be performed at any point during any player's Turn, except during Combat or when your Town Action would interrupt another Action. For example, players cannot draw Spell cards simultaneously using the Spell Book Token.

When a player announces that they are about to start Combat, you may react to it with any number of Town Actions before performing any of the steps of setting up Combat. (p. 41)

After performing a Town Action, flip the respective Token on its inactive side on your Town Board. You cannot use that Action again until the start of the next Round, when the Tokens are refreshed.

Build Token, used to expand your Town (p. 30).

Population Token, used to recruit and reinforce units (p. 36) or to recruit a Secondary Hero (p. 20).

Spell Book Token, used to purchase Spells (p. 26). Requires the Mage Guild (p. 30) to be built; cannot be used in the same Round when you build it.

Example Player Turn

Alice, who is playing the Hero Catherine the Knight, begins her Turn. She has 3 cards in her hand from the previous Round, and decides to discard 2 of them before drawing cards from her Deck up to her Hand Limit. The current limit is 5, since her Main Hero is Level III, so she draws 4 cards after discarding (see Level Effects, p. 21).

She then spends her Build Token to construct the ★ Dwelling, and then her Population Token to recruit (p. 36) the ★ unit Champions. She can do this, as she had previously built the prerequisite lower Level Dwellings (★ and ☆) and has enough Resources (p. 29) to both Build the Dwelling and to recruit the Champions.

Now prepared for an upcoming battle, she spends a Movement Point to move her Main Hero to an adjacent Field currently occupied by Sandro the Necromancer, an enemy Main Hero controlled by Bob. As Alice announces her intent to start Combat, both players still have an opportunity to perform Town Actions.

Morale Actions

Players can gain or lose Morale through various game effects. When you gain Morale, take a Positive Morale Token. You may only have one such Token. If you are about to gain a second Token, you may immediately spend the first one before gaining the second. A Positive Morale Token may be spent to perform any of the following Actions at any time:

- Draw a card from your Deck.
- Discard any number of cards, then draw that many cards.
- Reroll any Die you have thrown.

If you lose Morale, discard a Positive Morale Token if you have one, otherwise gain a Negative Morale Token. Inversely, gaining Positive Morale while you have a Negative Morale Token discards the Token. If you were to gain a second Negative Morale Token, you must instead **discard your hand of cards** the next time you end your Turn.

The Necropolis Faction ignores any Morale effects. They cannot ever gain or lose Morale for any reason.

Morale cards

You can use Morale cards **instead** of Tokens. During setup, remove all Morale cards with the Battlefield symbol, unless you're playing Adventure or Skirmish (p. 56). Then shuffle the Positive and Negative Morale cards separately and place them face down.

Positive Morale card

Negative Morale card

1. Name
2. Effect
3. Battlefield symbol
   (Use such cards only in Adventure and Skirmish (p. 56) games)

Every time you **gain** Morale, discard a Negative Morale card (if you have any); otherwise:

- In Adventure and Skirmish (p. 56): Search (2) Positive Morale card and put the unwanted card to the bottom of the Deck.
- In regular games: draw 1 Positive Morale card.

You may have **2 Positive Morale cards at a time**. Don't draw a third card.

Every time you **lose** Morale, discard a Positive Morale card (if you have any); otherwise draw 1 Negative Morale card (no Searching!). You may have an **unlimited number of Negative Morale cards**.

Place newly gained Morale cards face up near your Hero Board. Positive Morale cards may be used at any moment you wish. Negative Morale cards must be used the next time when the situation indicated by the card occurs. **Put used cards at the bottom of their respective Decks**. If you must draw a Morale card but the respective Morale Deck is empty, reshuffle its Discard Pile to form a new Deck.

HEROES

Players always control a Main Hero and may additionally also recruit a Secondary Hero. A "player's Hero" may refer to either of them. Heroes are used to perform Movement Actions on the game Board and to start Combats against enemies in order to reach a Scenario victory condition.

Main Hero

The Main Hero is represented by its chosen model, Hero Board, and your Deck. Each Faction's Main Hero has 3 . Only the Main Hero can use your Deck.

Each Main Hero starts the game at Level I and can advance up to Level VII by gaining Experience. Experience is gained from winning Combat (p. 44), visiting certain Locations (p. 73) and the Treasure Die (p. 73). Gaining 1 Experience is represented by the symbol .

Secondary Hero

If you control a Town or a Settlement, a Secondary Hero can be Hired by flipping your **Population Token** and paying 10 .

> Units **cannot** be recruited or reinforced (p. 36) while using the Population Token to recruit a Secondary Hero.

Your Secondary Hero uses the remaining Hero model of your Faction. You may wish to mark this model with a token such as a Faction Cube to differentiate it from the Main Hero. After Hiring a Secondary Hero, place the model in a Town or Settlement you control. **You can only have one Secondary Hero at a time**.

Secondary Heroes have **2** ; when you gain a Secondary Hero, take an additional set of 2 Movement Tokens to represent their MP. They do not have their own Hero Board, **cannot gain Experience**, **cannot play cards from your Deck during Combat**, but use **the same units** your Main Hero does. If a Secondary Hero gains any cards, place them into your hand as normal (see Deck-building, p. 22). Secondary Heroes are considered to have the same Level as the Main Hero for the purposes of resolving Quick Combat (p. 40).

If your Secondary Hero is attacked by an enemy Hero, you can choose to have that Hero be instantly defeated instead of fighting a Combat (p. 44). When a Secondary Hero is defeated, remove them from the game. They can be recruited again with another use of the Population Token.

Hero Board Anatomy

1. **Name** – The Hero's name. Used for identification. Has no gameplay effect.
2. **Class** – The Hero's class. Has no gameplay effect.
3. **Type** – The Hero's type (Might or Magic). Determines the amount of Magic Arrow° Spells in your Starting Deck (1 or 2 respectively).
4. **Faction Color** – Reminder for the color of the Faction's Cubes and miniatures.
5. **Attack** – Number of Attack° cards in your Starting Deck.
6. **Defense** – Number of Defense° cards in your Starting Deck.
7. **Power** – Number of Power° cards in your Starting Deck.
8. **Knowledge** – Number of Knowledge° cards in your Starting Deck.
9. **Starting Ability** – Reminder for the unique Ability card the Hero starts with.
10. **Hero Specialty** – Reminder for the Specialty cards the Hero adds to their Deck at the start of the game and after specific Level ups. Each Hero has three Specialty cards.
11. **Level Tracker** – Whenever a Main Hero gains 1 or more Experience, move the Cube that number of steps on this track. When the Cube reaches the next slot on the upper row, the Hero gains a Level.

Level Effects

Main Heroes always start each Scenario at Level I and may Level up by gaining Experience. The most common sources of gaining Experience are the Treasure Dice (p. 73) and Combat (p. 44). Each new Level up requires **2 Experience**. When a Main Hero reaches a new Level, resolve the effects of the Level up immediately. Gaining Experience at Level VII has no effect.

The Level Tracker on your Hero Board shows the following effects:

- The Cube's position shows your Main Hero's current Level and amount of Experience gained.
- At Levels **II**, **III**, **V**, and **VII** (marked with silver Roman numerals on the tracker), Search (2) the Ability Deck (p. 22) and add the chosen card to your hand.
- At Levels **I**, **IV**, and **VI** (marked in gold), gain the corresponding Specialty card (p. 27) and add it to your hand. Your first Specialty card is typically gained before the game starts.
- Each time you reach a new Hand Limit slot, your Hand Limit increases from that point on (4 → 5 → 6 → 7).
- Each time you reach an Expert Effects slot, you may play one additional card for its Expert Effect per Round (up to a maximum of 3 at Level **VI**).

STRETCH GOALS 2 EXPANSION

You can use Expert Effect Markers to track the usage of Expert Effects.

DECK-BUILDING

Player Decks

All players have a unique Deck which represents their Main Hero's Abilities and equipment. Decks may contain Statistic, Ability, Spell, Artifact and the Main Hero's Specialty cards. Each player's Deck starts with 9 cards, built during the game's setup.

General Card Rules

1. Cards can be played **only on your Turn**, or in a Combat (p. 40) involving your **Main Hero**.
2. After a card is used, discard it. Each player has their own separate Discard Pile.
3. If your Deck is empty when you need to draw a card, **shuffle your Discard Pile** into a new Deck to draw from.
4. Whenever your Hero gains a card for any reason, put it **directly into your hand** unless otherwise stated.
5. Whenever you are instructed to **Search** (X) the Ability, Artifact, or Spell Deck, you may either look at the top (X) cards from the specified Deck, take one of them to your hand, and discard the others, **OR** instead of looking at the top (X) cards, gain the top face-up card from that Deck's Discard Pile.
6. The Ability, Artifact, and Spell Decks each have their own Discard Piles, created during the setup, which help you identify these Decks. If a Deck ever runs out of cards, reshuffle it and discard its top card to form a new Discard Pile. Whenever one of these Discard Piles is empty, **refill it** with that Deck's top card.
7. Cards have the following types of effects:
   - **Instant** Effects are resolved immediately.
   - **Activation** Effects can only be played when Activating your own unit in Combat.
   - **Map** Effects cannot be used during Combat.
   - **Ongoing** Effects last until they are used up or until the player who played them starts their next Turn (whichever happens first).

     STRONGHOLD EXPANSION
     CONFLUX EXPANSION
     COVE EXPANSION

     You can use Time Tokens to track the duration of Ongoing Effects.

   - **Permanent** cards stay in play until discarded or replaced. They are played the same way as and cards. **You may only have one permanent card at a time**; playing another discards the first. While a Permanent card is in play, you may use either its Basic or Expert Effect, but not both simultaneously.
8. Whenever you are instructed to **remove a card**, remove it completely from the game.

Searching Example

Bob, playing as Deemer the Warlock, has built a Mage Guild during the previous Game Round, enabling him to now use his Spell Book Token to purchase additional Spells.

He spends the token and pays the cost of 5 indicated on his Town Board, allowing him to ***Search (2)*** *the Spell Deck.*

He now has the choice of either gaining the top Card of the Spell Card Discard Pile, or drawing the top two cards of the Spell Deck and gaining one of them. He is not interested in gaining the Spell Curse, which is on top of the Discard Pile, and instead decides to draw two cards – a Magic Arrow and a Fireball.

He decides to keep the Fireball, placing it into his hand and discarding the Magic Arrow into the Spell Discard Pile.

Statistic and Ability Cards

All Statistic and Ability cards have a **Basic Effect** and a stronger **Expert Effect** (crown), which is shown below the Basic Effect. Whenever you play a Statistic or Ability card, you must choose which effect you are using. The number of crown Effects you can use each Round is limited by your Main Hero's Level (p. 21). Track the number of uses you have in any suitable manner, such as by moving Black Cubes on and off your Hero Board.

Necromancy cards° are limited to the Necropolis Faction (skull). When a non-Necropolis player draws a Necropolis-specific card from the Ability Deck, they may either discard it and draw a new card as a replacement or gain it. Non-Necropolis players **cannot use** Necropolis-specific cards from their hand in any way besides for effects that discard them.

Statistic card

INFERNO EXPANSION

Empowered Statistic card

Empowered Statistic cards

These cards are more powerful versions of the normal Statistic cards. They have only one effect which is identical to the normal Statistic's Expert effect, but does not require using your crown.

These cards can be gained via certain game effects, such as visiting a Star Axis (p. 82).

Ability card

NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

Empowered Ability card

Empowered Ability cards

The Empowered Ability cards work very similarly to Empowered Statistic cards. Their only effect corresponds to the Expert effect of normal Ability cards, but without requiring you to use your crown.

These cards can be gained by spending Empowered Ability Tokens (p. 25), which are only available in certain Scenarios (e. g. "Island of Fire" from the Naval Battles Mission Book).

1. Name
2. Basic Effect
3. Expert Effect
4. Necropolis-specific card

Empowered Ability Tokens

Empowered Ability cards improve your Hero's Ability cards. You can gain them by spending Empowered Ability Tokens. You can use one of these Tokens at the moment you gain a new Ability card, regardless of how you obtain it. If you use such a Token, discard it, remove the just-gained normal Ability card from the game, and gain the corresponding Empowered Ability card in its stead. There's only one copy of each Empowered Ability card, so if one player takes a particular Empowered Ability card, they prevent other players from obtaining it. If an Empowered Ability card isn't available, you can't spend the Empowered Ability Token and must keep it for later turns.

You can gain Empowered Ability Tokens only in certain Scenarios (e. g. "Island of Fire" from the Naval Battles Mission Book).

Gaining Empowered Ability Example

Bob playing as Crag Hack reaches Level II. He performs the Search (2) action and draws two cards from the Ability Deck. The cards are Offense and Wisdom. He chooses Offense and places the other card on the discard pile.

Bob happens to have an Empowered Ability Token. He may either use it, or save the token for later. He decides to use it, so he removes the "Offense" Ability card and discards the Empowered Ability Token to take the Empowered "Offense" Ability card instead.

Spell Cards

The effects of a Spell card depend on the amount of you play. The topmost, basic effect usually has no additional cost. To use a stronger effect 4, pay the indicated cost 3. You pay by playing other cards for their **Empower** effect (e.g. the Power° Statistic card) **together** with the Spell. All the played this way is consumed and cannot be saved for later. Each Spell card also has an alternative +1 effect 5. See examples of empowering on page 33.

Spell card

1. Spell Name
2. School of Magic
3. Cost to empower
4. Spell Effect
5. Alternative Effect

Additional Spell rules:

- You may use a cheaper effect than the you paid for.
- You may resolve cards with + effects (e.g. Sorcery°) before deciding which Spell to cast.
- During Combat, each player may play **only one Spell card per Combat Round** for its primary effect. Some effects, such as Knowledge,° increase this limit.
- When you use an effect that lets you cast a Spell from outside your hand (such as directly from the Spell Deck), place that Spell into your Discard Pile after casting it. These Spells also count against your Combat Round Spell limit.
- Some Spell cards with complex effects use keywords or require special components; see Card Effect Keywords (p. 86).
- Spells can be traded (p. 52) in Alliance and Cooperative Scenarios.

Schools of Magic

All Spell cards belong to one School of Magic: either Air, Fire, Earth or Water. Spells with one School symbol on them are called **Basic Spells**, while Spells with four identical symbols are called **Expert Spells**. **Magic Arrow**° is a Basic Spell; when casting the **Magic Arrow**, you must select which School it belongs to. By default there's no difference, but certain game effects can refer to specific Schools and to Basic/Expert Spells.

School of Fire

School of Water

School of Air

School of Earth

Hero Specialty Cards

Hero Specialty cards are gained from Level ups (p. 21). Each Main Hero has a unique set of Specialty cards. While some of these cards have effects which resemble Spell cards and even make use of , Specialty cards are their **own unique category of cards**. For example, the limit of 1 Spell per Combat Round doesn't apply to Specialty cards.

A Level IV Specialty card, belonging to Catherine the Knight.

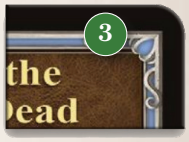
A Level I Specialty card, belonging to Deemer the Warlock. It uses , but does NOT belong to any School of Magic, despite the imagery.

Artifact Cards

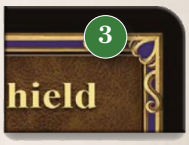
Artifact cards have a top and bottom effect. When you play one, you must **choose which effect** you are using. They are divided into 3 Levels: Minor, Major, and Relic, with different border color. These Levels relate to the overall Power of the card and may be referenced when resolving certain effects or during Scenario setup. Otherwise, all Artifact cards are normally shuffled together to form the Artifact Deck regardless of their Level. They are gained through map exploration.

Artifacts can be traded (p. 52) in Alliance and Cooperative Scenarios.

Major Artifact



Minor Artifact



Relic Artifact

1. Name
2. Effect
3. Level
4. Flavor text

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

Spell Scroll Cards

During setup shuffle 10 of the Spell Scroll cards into the Artifact Deck. Set the remaining 10 cards aside to form a Spell Scroll Deck. Some locations or Scenario effects may call for them later.

Spell Scroll card

When you gain a Spell Scroll, place it next to your Hero Board, take the two top cards from the Spell Deck and place them face-down on the Spell Scroll. You can look at these Spells at any time and they don't count toward your Hand Limit. You can only have two Spell Scrolls at a time. If you gain a third one, draw the new Spells normally and then decide whether to discard the newly gained Spell Scroll or replace one you already have (including all Spells on it).

You can play Spells from a Spell Scroll like any other Spell with the following exceptions:

- They don't count towards your Spell Limit. You can also play a Spell from your hand during this Combat Round.
- You may use the Spell's **lowest Power effect**, without needing to pay its cost (e.g. in case of Implosion° the cost is 1). You can't empower the Spell with from any source.

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

- They can't be used to increase the of another Spell.
- You can sell Spell Scrolls (p. 52) at a Trading Post for 2 per each Spell on it.
- After using or selling those Spells, the Spell card is **removed**, not discarded.

If the last Spell on a Spell Scroll is used or sold, place the Spell Scroll back in its Deck.

Spell Scrolls are not part of your Deck, therefore they are not carried over between Scenarios in a Campaign.

RAMPART EXPANSION
COVE EXPANSION

War Machine Cards

War Machines are permanent cards that can be bought at either a Trading Post (p. 78) or a War Machine Factory (p. 78). If you buy one at the Trading Post, **you cannot use** any of the other normal functions of that Field during that visit. War machines are also more expensive at the Trading Post.

War Machine card

1. Name
2. Effect
3. Cost in a War Machine Factory
4. Cost in a Trading Post

RESOURCES

There are three types of Resources in the game: Gold, Building Materials, and Valuables. Resources are spent during the game to expand your Town (p. 30), to recruit units (p. 36), and to purchase Spells (p. 26). You can gain Resources from the Settlements and Mines (p. 76) that you have flagged (p. 32), and also by playing Cards and rolling Resource Dice. Whenever a player's Resource Production is increased or decreased, move that Resource's Cube on its production track the appropriate number of spaces.

Resource Production Tracker

Gold

Building Materials

Valuables

Players start each Scenario with the number of Resources indicated in that Scenario's setup. Resources can also be traded (p. 52). There's no limit to the amount of Resources you can have.

Possible Resource Die results:

- 2 — 2 × Building Materials
- 4 — 4 × Building Materials
- 1 — 1 × Valuables
- 2 — 2 × Valuables
- 3 — 3 × Gold
- 6 — 6 × Gold

TOWN

Each Faction has their own Town, located in the center of their Starting Tile. The Town is your most important location, as many Scenarios may end (p. 11) if it's flagged (p. 32) by an enemy Hero.

The contents of your Town and overall Faction status are represented by the Town Board. It shows your currently built Buildings, Resource costs for future Buildings, your Resource incomes, and status of Town Action Tokens.

All Factions are able to Build the following Buildings in their Town:

- **City Hall** – Provides Resource income or a Faction-Specific Ability.
- **Citadel** – Allows you to reinforce units when using the Population Token. Also protects your Town (p. 46) when it is attacked.
- **Mage Guild** – Gains you Spells (p. 26) – both upon building it and later via the Spell Book Town Action (p. 18).
- , **Faction Buildings** – two Faction-Specific Buildings with unique effects.
- , , **Unit Dwellings** – Allows you to recruit units of your Faction. Dwellings have three Levels that unlock new units, which must be built in the following order:

One Building may be built each Round by using the Build Token. When you build a Building, pay its cost in Resources, flip the Build Token to its inactive side, and place the new Building Tile into its proper slot on the Town Board. If the Building has any immediate effects upon Building it, resolve them now.

Built Buildings are always represented by a symbol within a circle. Buildings that can be built in the future are represented by a rectangle that contains the Building's cost in Resources. Some Building Tiles are double-sided and may later be flipped to represent two different Buildings at the same time. Such Buildings must be **built in order**, one at a time.

MAP ELEMENTS

Each Scenario is built using four types of Map Tiles. Players start on their Faction-Specific Starting (I) Tile. Other Tiles may be placed and discovered as described on the next page. During the game's setup, all face-down Tiles should be selected randomly from the pool of possible Tiles as described by the Scenario and shuffled, keeping them face-down.

The **Roman numeral** on each Tile describes the overall **difficulty of Neutral Units** on that Tile. Starting (I) Tiles are the easiest while Center (VI–VII) Tiles are the most difficult.

Types of Map Tiles

1. Starting Map Tiles: I
2. Far Map Tiles: II–III
3. Near Map Tiles: IV–V
4. Center Map Tiles: VI–VII

Map Tile Anatomy

Each Map Tile is divided into 7 separate **Fields** that your Heroes can **visit**. When your Hero moves to a Field, they must immediately visit it if unguarded, or first start a Combat (p. 40) against the enemies guarding it before visiting. Empty Fields do nothing when visited. Solid yellow lines on a Field's edge cannot be passed through. Roman numerals written on a Field indicate that the Field is guarded by Neutral Units that must be fought to visit it, see the table on the back cover.

> A Blocked Field cannot be entered, but can be exited.

Map Tile Anatomy

1. Empty Field
2. Location
3. Artifact Symbol
4. Field Difficulty
5. Border line
6. Blocked Field
7. Tile name like `F2` or `#N3`

Location Categories

Visiting Fields provides Heroes with benefits, such as gaining Resources or cards (see All Map Locations, p. 73). There are three categories of Fields:

- **Visitable** – Once you visit this Field, place a Black Cube on it. Treat it as an Empty Field as long as it has a Black Cube.
- **Flaggable** – These Fields can be captured by players and provide passive benefits. When you visit one, place your Faction Cube on it. Enemy Heroes who visit your flagged Fields will replace your Cube with theirs to **steal** the Field's effects. Allied Heroes treat flagged Fields **as if they were empty**.
- **Revisitable** – You can visit this Field multiple times. Do not place any Cubes when you visit it. If you are already on this Field, you may pay 1 MP to visit this Field again.

Placing and Discovering New Tiles

Heroes may spend 1 MP to either reveal an adjacent face-down Tile, or to place a Far (II–III) Map Tile from their own supply of Tiles (scenario rules determine the Tiles in your own supply). All face-down Tiles should be kept **hidden from all players** until they are about to be placed or revealed. New Tiles must be placed adjacent to the Hero who spends the MP, and connected to at least two other existing Tiles. New Tiles must also be positioned so that there is a valid path that eventually connects them with all other Tiles. You may always rotate Map Tiles when placing or revealing them.

> When you visit a Visitable Field, **you must** place a Black Cube on that Field even if you cannot or choose not to use that Field's effects.

You cannot add this Tile here

You can add this Tile here, because it will be adjacent to two other Tiles

Example "Empowering Spells and flagging a guarded Mine"

Alice wants to capture an adjacent Mine (p. 76) by flagging it with her Main Hero, Sandro the Necromancer. She spends 1 MP to move onto the Mine, which begins Combat (p. 40) against Neutral Units, since the Field has a Difficulty Rating (p. 10) and has not been previously flagged by any player.

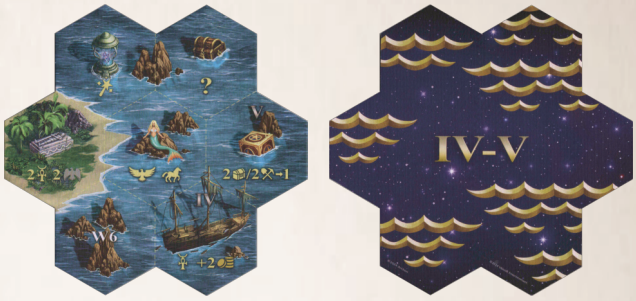
The Mine turns out to be guarded by Griffins with 4 . Alice's current hand consists of a Power card, a Magic Arrow, Sorcery, and a Town Portal. During the Combat, Alice decides to cast an offensive Spell, as she already holds a Magic Arrow. She first plays Sorcery for its effect, which also draws her a card: a Lightning Bolt. She casts the Lightning Bolt instead, empowering it with the already played Sorcery and with Magic Arrow's alternative (bottom) effect. The Lightning Bolt deals 4 , killing the Griffins, so Alice wins the Combat. The Combat lasted only one Round. Alice could not have cast both Magic Arrow and the drawn Lightning Bolt, because players may play only one Spell card per Combat Round. For winning the Combat, Sandro gains his second , reaching Level II, so Alice Searches (2) the Ability Deck before visiting the Field.

Alice now flags the Mine by placing one of her Faction Cubes on it. Flagging this Mine increases her Building Materials production by 2, and she immediately gains the Mine's production value of 2 because she was the first player to flag it. Afterwards, Alice wants to go back to defend a previously flagged Settlement by casting the Town Portal still in her hand. Her Hero is Level II, so she can empower the Spell with the Power card's Expert Effect , which grants her an additional Movement Point after casting it.

COVE EXPANSION

Sea Map Tiles

Sea Map Tiles have a unique backside and during setup are placed as shown in the Scenario Map Layout. Discovering them works as with regular Tiles. Sea Map Tiles may contain both land and sea Fields. Movement from land to land, from sea to sea, or from sea to land works as normal. However, when your Hero **enters a sea Field from a land Field**, their movement for the Turn ends. You may use unspent MP for other Actions (for example, to extend Combat (p. 43) against Neutral Units), but you cannot move anymore that Turn, not even with the help of card effects.



Sea Map Tile

CONFLUX EXPANSION

Elemental Map Tiles

Each of the Elemental Map Tiles is associated with one School of Magic (p. 26). When your Main Hero stands on such a Tile, all cast Spells from that School of Magic have their increased by 1.

Elemental Fire Tile

Elemental Water Tile

Elemental Air Tile

Elemental Earth Tile

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

Subterranean Map Tiles

Subterranean Map Tiles have a unique backside and are placed during setup as shown in the Scenario Map Layout. They work similarly to regular Map Tiles, except that **you cannot move between a Surface and a Subterranean Tile without using a Subterranean Gate** (p. 35) **in between** or a Town Portal° Spell. No other movement effects from cards can allow you to move from one to the other. You also may not discover a Subterranean Map Tile while standing on a Surface Map Tile and vice versa. Treat both Fields of the Subterranean Gate Token **as one Field**. When a Hero enters a Field with a Subterranean Gate, discover the Map Tile on the other side for free (if it is still not discovered). Otherwise treat a Subterranean Gate Token as an empty Field.

Surface Map Tile

Subterranean Gate

Subterranean Map Tile

Placing and Discovering Location Tokens

Location Tokens are added by several expansions to the game. They are placed either separately or on specific Fields of the Map Tile when a Hero discovers one with associated Token, and overwrite the original Location they are placed on. Tokens cannot be placed on other Location Tokens, Blocked Fields, or Fields containing Locations required to meet any of the Scenario's victory conditions. The effects of visiting the Location Tokens are described in All Map Locations (p. 82).

CONFLUX EXPANSION

Monolith Tokens

The position of Monoliths (p. 83) is determined by the Scenario Map Layout. If you discover a Tile with one of these Tokens on it, discover the Tile normally, and then place the Token on the Field indicated by the Scenario Map Layout, or a Field of your choosing if it's not specified.

COVE EXPANSION

Whirlpool Tokens

Discovering Whirlpools (p. 83) follows the same rules as discovering Monoliths.

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

Subterranean Gate Tokens

Subterranean Gates are also determined by the Scenario Map Layout and connect both a Surface Map Tile and an adjacent Subterranean Map Tile. They cannot be placed outside the Map Tiles. After discovering one of the corresponding Map Tiles you may choose the position of the Subterranean Gate Token as long as it connects the two indicated Map Tiles without covering forbidden Fields.

The Scenario Map Layout only shows **which two Tiles are connected**, not the exact Fields the Token is placed on.

NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

Creature Bank Tokens

As an **optional rule** you can decide to play with Creature Banks (p. 66). If you do, each time you discover a Far (II–III) or Near (IV–V) Map Tile, you may decide to draw a Creature Bank Token corresponding to the discovered Map Tile, and – contrary to the normal rules – you can place it **only on its Blocked Field**.

UNITS

In addition to their Hero and its associated Deck, players also have **a Deck of Unit cards** which represent the armies moving with their Heroes. Every Faction has access to **7 different units**, each with unique stats and abilities. Units are necessary for winning Combat and fulfilling Scenario goals. Each Scenario's setup instructions indicate which unit cards should be included in your initial Unit Deck. This Deck should be kept clearly separated from the rest of your Faction's Units.

Each Faction unit is double-sided, with a weaker "Few" side, and a stronger "Pack" side. "Few" units may be upgraded to "Packs" by **reinforcing** them, while taking damage can subsequently reduce a unit back to its "Few" side. Units should be always kept on their correct side when moved or inspected.

A player's Unit Deck may have any number of units, but **only up to 5 units** can be selected to fight during Combat Setup (p. 41). If a unit is defeated in Combat, **discard it** from your Unit Deck.

Units of your Faction may be recruited and reinforced by flipping the Population Token and paying the unit's recruitment or reinforcement cost. When you do so, you can instantly recruit and reinforce **any number** of times, provided you have enough Resources and the prerequisite Buildings to do so.

Recruiting a unit requires that your Town has a Dwelling of that unit's Level (★☆☆). **Reinforcing** requires that your Town has a Citadel in addition to a Dwelling of that unit's Level.

Any effects which instruct you to reinforce (e.g., Necromancy°) **do not** require spending your Population Token nor owning a Citadel or any Dwellings.

If all units in your Unit Deck are defeated, **immediately** replace your Unit Deck with the starting units of the Scenario. Defeated Faction units can always be recruited again with another use of the Population Token.

Unit Card Anatomy

Attack – The amount of damage this unit deals when it attacks.

Defense - The amount by which this unit reduces oncoming Attack damage. Does not apply to damage received from Spells or other non-attack effects.

HP - The amount of damage required to defeat the unit. "Few" units are discarded from Combat and their owner's Unit Deck when defeated. "Pack" units are turned back to "Few" units, with any excess damage placed on their "Few" side. Units retain their "Few" or "Pack" status between Combats. All damage is healed from all units at the end of Combat.

Initiative - Determines when the unit activates during Combat. Units with a higher Initiative activate first.

Unit card (Few)

Unit card (Pack)

1. Name
2. Tier
3. Type
4. Attack
5. Defense
6. HP
7. Initiative
8. Recruitment cost
9. Reinforcement cost
10. Pack symbol
11. Special Ability

Most units have a **special ability:**

- **Activation** ➡ resolves when the unit is activated.
- **Attack** resolves when the unit attacks during its Activation. In case of multiple attacks, resolve the effect for **the first attack only**.
- **Other** may be resolved instead of the unit's normal Activation. It replaces all movement and/or attacking.
- **Passive** resolves whenever its condition is met.
- **Retaliate** resolves when the unit retaliates.
- **Map** effects may be resolved once per Turn outside of Combat as long as a unit with this effect is in your Unit Deck.

Some complex unit abilities use keywords or require special components (p. 89).

Unit Types

There are three types of Units:

- **Ground** units may move up to 3 spaces and then attack an adjacent enemy.
- **Flying** units may move up to 3 spaces, **ignoring Combat Obstacles**, and then attack an adjacent enemy.
- **Ranged** units may attack **any enemy unit anywhere** and then move up to 1 space OR move up to 1 space without attacking.

If a unit is next to an enemy unit, its attack target **must be** that adjacent enemy. When attacking an adjacent enemy in this way, the unit suffers a Combat penalty: throw two Attack Dice (instead of one) and **apply the smaller result**.

This penalty is also applied if the unit attacks from its own Backline into the enemy's Backline. Walls and Gates may also reduce (p. 46) the damage from attacks.

Neutral Units

Neutral Units guard the various locations on the Game Map. Starting and winning Combat against them is necessary to visit most Locations. Neutral Units are spread into four different tiers, each with their own Deck. In addition to , and , there are also Azure Neutral Units which are the strongest in the game.

Each of these Decks should always be kept separate from each other and shuffled during setup. If a Neutral Unit Deck ever runs out of cards, reshuffle the discard into a new Deck. When a Combat against Neutral Units starts, draw the appropriate number of units from each tier (see the table on the back cover) to take part in that Combat.

It is possible for players to gain Neutral Units to their Unit Deck through various effects, such as Scenario-Specific Rules or the Diplomacy° Ability card. **Neutral Units cannot be reinforced**, as they are single sided. Whenever a Neutral Unit is defeated from anywhere, place it into the appropriate Neutral Discard Pile.

> Having a Dwelling built in your Town allows you to draw an unit card using the basic (top) effect of a Diplomacy° Ability card. This effect does not apply to other cases, like Dungeon's Portal of Summoning.

Neutral Unit

NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

Creature Bank Unit

See Creature Banks (p. 66).

CONFLUX EXPANSION

Summoned Elemental Unit

Summoned Elemental units don't have nor . See Summoning (p. 88).

Example "Pack and Few"

Bob, playing as Alamar the Warlock, casts a Magic Arrow against Alice's pack of Skeletons, empowering the Spell by 2 with the Expert Effect of a Power card.

The Skeletons take 3 damage from the Spell. Their Defense of 1 does not reduce the damage, because it only applies against attacks. The Skeletons have a HP of only 2, so they are now turned to their "Few" side and 1 leftover damage is placed on them.

COMBAT

Combat with **Neutral Units** starts when a Hero moves to one of the **unvisited** Fields:

- A Field with a Roman numeral signifying the type and number of Neutral Units guarding that Field, or

NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

- A Creature Bank Location (p. 84). In this case, follow the rules for Combat against Creature Banks (p. 66).

Combat with **another player** can start in two ways:

- You move into any Field containing one of their Heroes.
- You move into a Town or Settlement owned by them, see Siege Combat (p. 46).

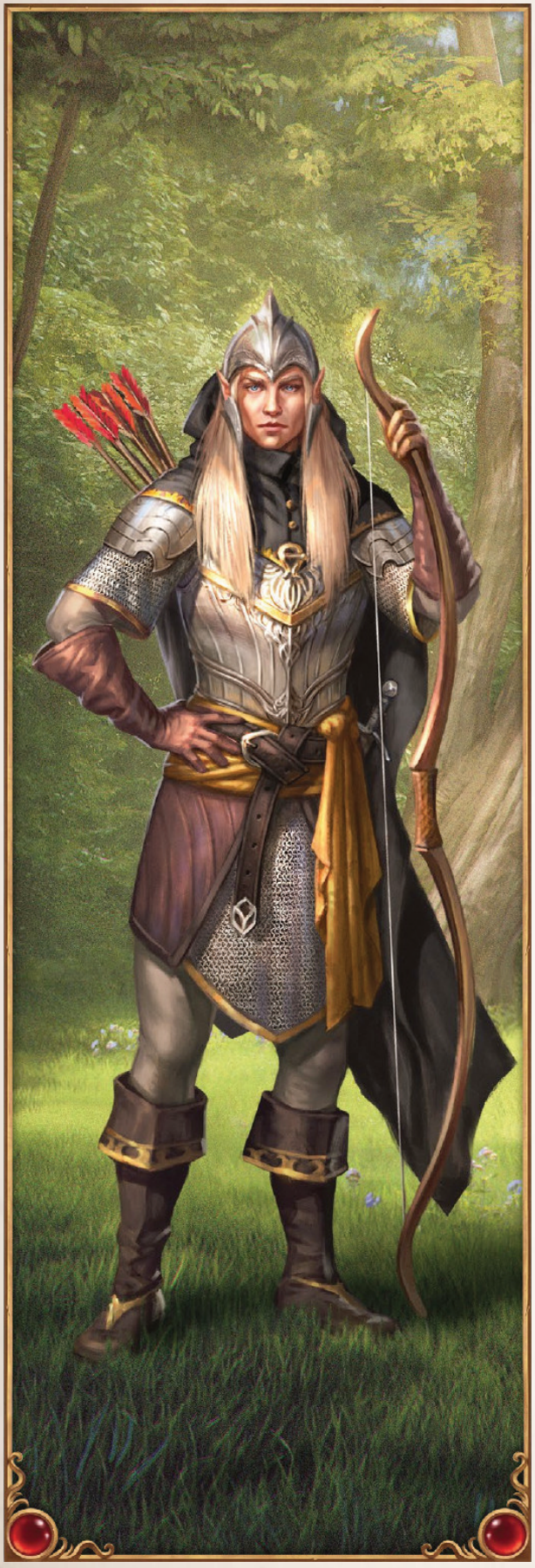
Players are able to start multiple Combats during their Turn.

When a Secondary Hero (p. 20) is attacked, they **may choose** to be instantly defeated (p. 44) instead of engaging in Combat, which helps to preserve the units.

Quick Combat

If your Hero's Level is higher than a Field's Difficulty when Combat against Neutral Units would begin, **no Combat** takes place. The player is considered to have beaten the Neutral Units by default and gains no rewards from the Combat itself before visiting the Field.

Combat Setup



Combat is resolved on the 4×5 Combat Board, which consists of two Backlines and two Frontlines on opposite ends, and a middle row. It can also be resolved on one of the alternative Boards (p. 67). Follow these steps when Combat begins against **Neutral Units**:

- Choose one of the Combat Board's sides as your own. Place up to 5 of your unit cards freely onto the Back and Frontlines of that side.
- Check the **Difficulty Table** (on the back cover) and draw the corresponding number of Neutral Unit cards from their Decks.
- The Neutral Units are placed differently depending on the Game Mode:
- In **Clash** or **Alliance** Scenarios, the enemy player sitting to your right controls the Neutral Units and decides their placement. units must be placed in the Backline if possible.
- In **Campaign** or **Cooperative** Scenarios, Neutral Units are placed from left to right from the player's perspective. First, place any units in the Backline. Then, place any or units in the Frontline. If there's not enough room to place a unit in its correct line, place them in the other one. Units must be placed in **descending** Initiative order. If there's a tie, place higher tier units first. If there's still a tie, the players decide the order. Check the **Combat against AI** (p. 48) section for detailed instructions.

Unit setup when fighting **other players**:

- The attacking player places up to 5 units on their chosen side of the Combat Board, followed by the defender.
- If the Combat takes place in a Town with a Citadel, the defender adds the Wall, Gate and Arrow Tower (p. 46) cards after placing their units.

Combat Terminology

The following terms are used to describe effects and elements during Combat:

Attacking Player – The player who started the Combat.

Defending Player – The player whom Combat was started against.

Activation – A unit activates when it is next in the Initiative order.

Adjacent Unit – A unit is directly adjacent to another if it is one space away in a cardinal direction (nondiagonal).

Combat Round – A full cycle of all units of each player being activated.

Combat Obstacles – Every card on the Combat Board is a Combat Obstacle. They block the movement of all non-flying units.

Attack Die – A red Die whose results range from −1 to +1. Roll the Die **whenever a unit attacks** and add the result to the unit's Attack value.

Retaliation Attack – If a unit survives an attack by an adjacent unit, it performs an attack back at that unit. Each unit can perform **only 1** Retaliation Attack per Combat Round. Retaliation Attacks function identically to normal attacks, but they cannot cause another Retaliation Attack. Mark units which have performed a Retaliation Attack this Round with a Black Cube.

Paralysis – Some effects place a Paralysis Token on units. If a unit would activate with a Paralysis Token on it, **skip its activation** and remove the Token instead. If the unit **is attacked or takes any damage** while having the Paralysis Token, remove it. The Token does not prevent units from performing Retaliation Attacks.

Paralysis Token

Defend – units may choose to gain a Defense Token and end the activation instead of attacking. When a unit with a Defense Token is attacked, make another roll with the attack Die after the initial attack roll. If you roll a "+1", the defending unit gains an extra 1 Defense for this attack. If a unit has a Defense Token at the start of its activation, discard it. The unit cannot take another Defense Action during that activation.

Defense Token

CONFLUX EXPANSION

Elemental Damage – If units deal elemental damage, they attack normally, but the resulting damage works similarly to dealt by Spells and ignores the unit's . Elemental damage does not count as damage from Spells.

Combat Round Structure

Combat is divided into Rounds, during which all of the units participating in that Combat **activate once** in Initiative order. After each unit has activated, a new Combat Round begins. Combat lasts until all units on one side are eliminated, a player has to **Retreat** when fighting Neutral Units, or a player **surrenders** to another player.

Structure of a Combat Round:

- Players activate their units in descending order of unit Initiative (p. 37). **If there's a tie**, alternate between attackers and defenders starting with the attacker's unit.
- When a unit activates, place a Faction Cube on it to indicate it has been activated this Combat Round.
- Activated units may move and attack according to their type (p. 38). Neutral Units controlled by the opposing player must always attack. If that is not possible, they spend all their movement to move towards the Hero's units.
- Instead of attacking, a unit may defend (p. 42). In Neutral Combat, the Neutral enemy units cannot defend, even when controlled by another player.
- Before a unit attacks, both players may play cards (p. 43). Cards are resolved in the order in which players play them.
- After a unit's attack has been declared and all cards have been played, roll the Attack Die. Modify the attacking unit's attack by the Die's result, then reduce it by the defending unit's Defense, and finally deal the rest as damage (p. 37) to the defending unit.
- If the defending unit was adjacent to the attacker, it retaliates (p. 42) if it hasn't done so this Round.
- Keep activating units until they've all been activated once. After the last unit's activation, the Round ends.

Campaign and Cooperative Combat

During these game modes, all enemy units activate as described in the AI Rules section (p. 48).

Using Cards During Combat

You may only use **one Spell per Combat Round**, unlike being able to play any number of other cards. Ongoing ↻ and ➡ activation effects can be used only **when activating one of your units and before it attacks**. Ongoing effects last until end of Combat or if the effect on the card is used up.

Instant ↯ cards may be played **at any time** except between rolling the Attack Die and resolving damage unless otherwise stated. **Reroll effects** affecting the Attack Die are an exception to this and may be played after the roll. Effects of increasing a unit's ⚔ (e.g. by the Statistics cards) expire whenever the first attack performed by that unit resolves or the activation ends, whichever comes first. Increased ⛊ expires in a similar way.

Combat Time Limits

Combats against Neutral Units have a time limit of **one Combat Round**. At the end of every Combat Round, you have an option to either **Retreat** or spend 1 from the Hero that started the Combat in order to play another Round. When you Retreat, end the Combat, and move the Hero that started the Combat back to the Field they **last visited**. Retreating has no other penalties.

> Combats against Azure ★ Units, other players, or AI Heroes (p. 49) have no time limit, and you cannot Retreat from them.

Combat against Neutrals has three possible outcomes:

- **Victory:** All Neutral Units are defeated.
- **Retreat:** The player runs out of time or loses all combating units, but still has units in their unit Deck.
- **Defeat:** The player loses all combating units and doesn't have any units in their unit Deck.

Combat against another player's Hero has two possible outcomes:

- **Victory/Defeat:** If all units on one side are defeated, the side with any surviving units is the winner, the other side is defeated.
- **Surrender:** Instead of activating one of their units, a Hero can decide to surrender to the other player's Hero by paying them 10 to prevent their army from being defeated. In this case, Combat ends immediately without having a winning or defeated Hero.

When Combat ends, all damage is healed from all surviving units. Move any player-owned units back to their unit Deck and discard any leftover enemy Neutral Units. Depending on the type and result of the Combat, players must resolve the following consequences for themselves:

A **Winning Hero** gets Experience (p. 44), if it was the Main Hero. If it was the attacker, they must visit the Field where the Combat took place.

A **Retreating Hero** from a Combat with Neutral Units has to move back to the last visited Field on the map (without visiting that Field).

A **defeated Main Hero** has to move to a friendly Town or Settlement. If they were defeated by another player's army (with or without a Hero), they gain 1 and have to pay 5 to the winner. Furthermore, they give a Faction Cube (p. 11) to the winning player. Defeating a Main Hero may cause Player Elimination (p. 11).

A **defeated Secondary Hero** (even instantly defeated without combat) is removed from the map. If defeated by another player's army they also get a Faction Cube.

A **Surrendering Hero** doesn't count as defeated. Move a surrendering Main Hero to a town or settlement, or remove a Secondary Hero from the map as if they had been defeated. The other player neither gets Experience nor Faction Cubes.

Remember to receive the starting units of the chosen Scenario for free each time your unit Deck is empty after a Combat.

Combat Experience

Winning Combat with your Main Hero usually grants them Experience. If either the Difficulty of the Neutral Field or the Level of a defeated enemy Main Hero was **equal** to your Level, gain 1 . If they were **higher** than your Level, gain 2 . Winning a Neutral Combat against a Neutral Azure Unit grants your Hero Level VII **immediately**. If you ever gain multiple Levels at the same time, resolve their effects in order. Level ups must be resolved before visiting the Field where the Combat happened.

Secondary Heroes cannot ever gain Experience. You also do not gain Experience from **defeating** a Secondary Hero, or if an enemy Hero **surrenders** to you.

Combat Example

Bob's Zombies are about to attack Alice's Griffins. As Bob announces the attack, both players now have a chance to modify the Attack or Defense of their own unit by playing any number of cards that increase an attacking unit's or a defending unit's .

Bob decides to play a +1 Attack card, increasing the Zombies' attack from 2 to 3. Alice responds by playing a +1 Defense card, increasing the Griffins' Defense from 0 to 1. They would both be permitted to play any number of additional cards in any order, but they decide to stop after playing these cards.

After all cards for the attack have been played, the Attack Die is thrown to further modify the amount of damage the attacking unit deals. Bob throws a +1. This increases the Zombies' attack from 3 to 4, which is then reduced by the Griffins' Defense of 1. Therefore, 3 damage is placed on the Griffins. Since they have a HP of 4, they are not flipped over to their "Few" side.

The Griffins do not have a Black Cube on them, therefore they now start a Retaliation Attack. The Cube would now normally be placed on them, however their Special Ability indicates that they may retaliate any number of times so the Cube is not placed.

Both players are allowed to modify the Statistics of their units again during the Retaliation Attack. The previously played Attack and Defense cards no longer have any effect.

When an enemy Hero attacks your Town or Settlement and your Hero is not present on that Field, you may immediately **pay 8 to defend with only your units**. You cannot use your Deck during this Combat, as your Main Hero is not present. Paying this Gold represents the cost of transporting the army there.

When you defend a Town **without a Citadel**, resolve Combat normally on the standard Combat Board. Defending a Settlement follows the same rules as defending a Town without a Citadel.

> **Note:** you cannot surrender when defending your Faction Town.

Defending a Town with a Citadel

When you defend your Town and it has a Citadel, you add the 3 Wall and 1 Gate Obstacles in any order to the middle row of the Combat Board after placing your units. **Don't use Walls and Gate** if you defend an enemy Town, which you've conquered before, **not even** if it is a Town with a Citadel. The Gate Card is **not an Obstacle** to the defending player. Defending units may move through the Gate and may stop on it.

Walls protect defending units behind them (p. 47).

The Wall and Gate Cards can be destroyed by any adjacent or unit's attack, even by your own defending units. These attacks don't count as normal attacks: They are always successful and don't activate any of the attacking unit's abilities, and you cannot play any cards or throw the Attack Die to affect the attack's result.

The defender also gains the Arrow Tower unit card which is placed next to the Combat Board. It acts like a Ranged unit, except that it is not affected by anything related to its positioning. For example, it never gets ranged penalty against enemy units and vice versa. Only Ranged attacks and card effects can destroy the Arrow Tower, but it is instantly destroyed when all Walls and the Gate are destroyed. The attacker doesn't need to destroy it to win the Combat.

For Arrow Tower rules in Solo Scenarios, see AI Siege (p. 48).

Protection from ⚔ Attacks

Defending units standing on their own side and **in the same column** as a non-destroyed Wall or Gate gain protection from ⚔ attacks. If they are targeted by a ⚔ attack performed from the opponent's side of the Combat Board, **reduce the attack's damage by 1**.

*When the Halberdiers are behind a non-destroyed Gate, they **are protected** when attacked from the opponent's side of the Combat Board. The ⚔ attack damage of Evil Eyes is **reduced by 1**.*

*Because the Halberdiers are not behind a non-destroyed Wall, **protection doesn't work**. Evil Eyes attack **without penalty**.*

AI RULES

AI rules apply to Enemy Heroes and all Combat encounters, including those against Neutral Units, in **Solo Campaigns** and **Cooperative** Scenarios.

Combat against AI

Foreword: these rules are intended to make fun challenging encounters, but still be simple enough to follow. You will likely find some loopholes which make the encounter too easy, but you may make AI behave more intelligently.

The rules for AI unit placement during setup are described in Combat section (p. 41).

When Neutral enemies or AI Heroes (p. 49) activate a unit, they follow a set of instructions:

- If it is an AI Hero, draw and resolve the next AI card (p. 50).
- Enemy Ground and Flying units prioritize attacking units of the **same** tier. If this is impossible, they attack the unit of a lower tier (in tier **descending** order, down to bronze), and if that is also impossible, they attack the unit of a higher tier (in tier **ascending** order).

  NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

  If your army includes Creature Bank Units (p. 66), enemy units prioritize attacking all other units first, and Creature Bank Units last.

  Example: has this priority: - - - - Creature Bank Units.
- Ranged units prioritize attacking other Ranged units of the same tier, then lower tier, and finally higher tier, using the same tier order as above. If there are no Ranged units for them to target, they prioritize Ground and Flying units in the same tier order.

  Example: has this priority: - - - - Creature Bank Units - - - - Creature Bank Units.

In both cases, if there is more than one valid target, they attack the closest one. If there is ever a tie between equally valid targets, the player chooses which unit is attacked.

NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

Creature Bank Units (p. 66) do not have a tier. Therefore, they ignore the tier order in the lists above and instead attack the nearest valid target.

Enemy units cannot defend (p. 42) unless instructed to.

AI Siege

If you are besieging an AI Town: When the Walls and Gate are mentioned in Combat preparation but no additional information on how to arrange them is given, place the Gate in front of the unit with the highest . By default, the units do not attack the Walls – they would rather fly over them to attack their target or move towards it through the Gate. If neither is possible, they take a Defend (p. 42) Action.

To the AI, the Arrow Tower (p. 46) counts as a Silver unit. However, if it has multiple equally valid targets to attack, it will attack the one with the least health remaining (the smallest difference between and current).

If AI Hero besieges you, the Arrow Tower counts as a Silver unit as well. Furthermore, and units attack the closest wall if no other enemy is in their reach.

AI Heroes

AI Heroes are used in Campaigns. AI Heroes do not have a Town Board, Resources, or a Hero Board. Their units are static and defined by the Scenario: locate the indicated unit cards during setup. If the unit indicates a unit tier (★, ☆, ★, or ★) instead of "Few" or "Pack", it is a Neutral Unit.

During setup, if multiple AI Heroes use the same unit and you do not have enough copies of its card, the AI Heroes must share it: set up everything without that card, then add it to the AI Hero's Army when you initiate Combat with them.

AI Heroes cannot surrender and you cannot surrender to them; they will always fight until they run out of units. Winning Combat against an AI Hero does not grant any rewards unless stated by the Scenario.

AI Hero Turns

Unless specified otherwise, AI Heroes start in their Town, take turns after the player, and have 3 MP, always spending them to perform the following actions in descending priority:

- If a player's Hero is on the same Tile as the AI, spend all MP to move towards them in an attempt to start Combat.
- If there are any Mines or Settlements the AI could flag on the same Tile, move towards the closest one.
- Otherwise, move toward the player's Town.

Repeat this sequence until all MPs are used up.

AI Heroes always **automatically win Combat** against any Neutral Units, while simultaneously **flagging or visiting all Fields** they happen to move through. They gain no benefits from any Fields.

AI Heroes must discover face down Map Tiles as normal by spending 1 MP before moving onto them. The player chooses that Tile's orientation.

AI Decks

1. Name
2. Description
3. Easy Modifier
4. Normal Modifier
5. Expert Modifier
6. Impossible Modifier
7. Card Type:
   - Might
   - Magic
   - Skill

AI card

AI Heroes use two Decks during Combat: the **AI Deck** and the **AI Spell Deck**. The AI Deck consists of three types of AI cards: Might, Magic, and Skill. Each Campaign Scenario lists the number and types of cards to include during setup. Choose these cards **randomly** when building the AI Deck. Before each Combat, shuffle the AI Deck and its discard pile together.

When an AI Hero **activates** a unit, draw an AI card and follow its instructions before the unit moves and/or attacks (p. 48). If the AI Deck is depleted during Combat, stop drawing from it. The effect of each AI card depends on the game's Difficulty (p. 10). If an AI Hero is instructed to draw a card, they will draw and resolve **another card** from the AI Deck.

AI Magic cards and AI Spell Deck

During setup find the Spells indicated in the Scenario and build the **AI Spell Deck**. Before each Combat, shuffle the AI Spell Deck and its discard pile together.

Whenever an AI Magic card is drawn, draw the next Spell from the AI Spell Deck and cast it. Discarded Spells go to its own AI Spell Discard Pile. If the AI Spell Deck empties before Combat ends, shuffle the AI Spell Discard Pile to form a new Spell Deck.

The AI Spell Deck may contain more Spell cards than there are Magic cards in the AI Hero's Deck. This is intentional: not all Spells will be used during Combat. Some are included for the sake of variety.

If the AI Hero is assigned a Spell card that is unavailable because it is in your Hero's Deck, and you do not have another copy, substitute it with a Magic Arrow° card.

For certains Spells it can be unclear how the AI is supposed to cast them. See Casting Complex Spells (p. 51) for explanations.

AI Skill cards

If Skill cards are included, search for and set aside the indicated card related to it (usually, an Ability), hereby referred to as "skill". Whenever an AI Hero uses the AI Skill card, use the skill, but do not discard it afterwards. Contrary to the regular rules, the AI Hero can use the skill again, when instructed to do so by the AI Deck. Discard the AI Skill card as usual.

Skills cannot be replaced, so if Scenario rules assign the AI Hero a card that your Hero has and you do not have another copy, remove that card from your Deck and **Search (3)** the respective card's Deck to compensate your Hero for the loss.

AI cards timing

After an AI card is resolved, discard it.

The Attack° Might card says about "unit that is about to attack", so if the currently activated unit doesn't have a valid target to attack, the Attack will apply to the next unit who is able to attack. Note that multiple unresolved cards can stack over successive activations. The same applies to any AI card which is not useful at the moment of drawing it.

If an AI card increased a unit's , or triggered another card which increased it, the AI card stays attached to the unit until the first defense happens.

AI Deck sharing

If there are multiple AI Enemy Armies in the Scenario, but the rules do not specify to which Enemy an AI Deck, an AI Spell Deck, or a Skill belongs, you should assume it is shared between them.

Casting complex Spells

In some Campaigns, enemies use Spells whose effects are not fully compatible with the standard use of AI Magic cards. To fully use their effects, here are extended descriptions of how AI Heroes should use each of these Spells. Scenarios can override these instructions.

Spells attacking multiple targets

Examples: Fireball,° Chain Lightning.°

When drawn, target any unit with one or two adjacent units from the player's army, prioritizing the groups where there are more higher-tier units. If there is more than one valid group, attack the one with the least health remaining (has the smallest difference between and current). If there is still more than one valid target, you can choose which unit is attacked. If there are no player units adjacent to one another, target units that are not adjacent to any of the AI units. If that is also not possible, do not use this Spell – instead, skip the AI card that activated this effect and put it on the bottom of the AI Deck, then shuffle this Spell back to the AI Spell Deck.

Instant Defense Spells

Example: Stone Skin.°

When drawn, put this card on the side of the Combat Board, then put a Defense Token on the unit with the highest to represent the card's effect – it stays there until the Defense is resolved. If that unit already has a Defense Token, place it on the unit with the next highest instead. In case of a tie in value, give preference to the unit of the highest tier, then to the greatest value of .

Healing Spells

Example: Cure.°

When drawn, remove the from the AI unit with the greatest value of taken, starting with the highest tier available. If no AI unit has any , put the AI card that triggered the Spell at the bottom of the AI Deck, then shuffle this Spell card back to the AI Spell Deck.

Single-round buffs

Example: Fire Shield.°

When drawn, check the tier of the unit on which you are about to cast the Spell and count how many units of the same or higher tier there are on the Board. If more than half of those units have already activated this Round, do not cast the Spell; instead, set it aside and cast it when the first AI unit activates next Round; skip drawing the AI card for that activation. Multiple delayed Spells may accumulate and be cast during the same activation.

Attack-weakening Spells

Example: Weakness.°

When drawn, if the AI's activated unit is about to perform an attack that will provoke a Retaliation, cast this Spell on the Retaliating enemy to lower their . If the AI's unit causes no Retaliation, do not cast this Spell; instead, ignore the AI card that activated the Spell and put it at the bottom of the AI Deck, then shuffle the Spell card back to the AI Spell Deck.

TRADING

Trading Post actions

When visiting a Trading Post Field (p. 78), choose one:

- Trade multiple Resources with the game in accordance with the table at the back cover.

RAMPART EXPANSION
COVE EXPANSION

- Buy a War Machine (p. 28) of your choice.

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

- Sell a Spell Scroll card (p. 28) for 2 per Spell on it. Remove sold Spells from the game, put the Spell Scroll card into Spell Scroll Deck.
- **Remove a single card** from your hand to gain 1 .

> Specialty, Statistic, Starting Ability and Magic Arrows° **cannot be removed** in the Trading Post.

In addition to the above, in **Cooperative Scenarios** players can **give** resources to other players an unlimited number of times during the same visit.

Other Trading actions

Certain game modes and game effects also allow you to trade:

- In **Alliance Scenarios**, allies may trade Resources freely at any time on their Turns except during Combat.
- In **Alliance and Cooperative Scenarios**, allies may trade **Spell** and **Artifact** cards in any mix if they have Heroes on adjacent Fields. Only **cards from their hands** may be traded and you must give and receive an equal number of cards.
- When other game effects allow you to **trade Resources** (e.g., Marketplace Event°), use the trade table as well.

SOLO CAMPAIGNS

A Campaign is a series of Scenarios designed for solo play.

Starting a Scenario

At the start of each Campaign Scenario, set your income by placing your Faction Cubes on spaces 10, 0, 0 of the Resource Production Tracker on the Town Board. Special rules in each Scenario can change these values. Campaigns have unique bonuses that **replace** the regular starting bonus from the chosen Difficulty (p. 10).

Prepare AI Enemies: their units (p. 49) and their AI Decks (p. 50).

Finishing a Scenario

After finishing a **Solo Campaign** Scenario, reset your Hero's Experience Level to I, and prepare the starting Deck for the next Scenario of the Campaign. It will consist of:

- all the Statistic (p. 24) cards from your Deck,
- Level I Specialty (p. 27) card,
- 5 other non-Specialty cards of your choice from your Deck.

Skip steps 11–13 of Setup (p. 12) for the next Scenario of the Campaign.

Note down the list of cards in your starting Deck. If you lose the Scenario, reset the Deck to the same list.

If your Hero is at some point given a Spell, Artifact, or Ability card that is unavailable, **Search (3)** the respective card's Deck to get another card in its stead.

Combat

See Combat against AI (p. 48) section.

Using different Heroes

Although each campaign has its own recommended Hero for whom it is balanced and who is also the protagonist of the story, you are free to play with any other Hero of the same Faction.

If you choose to change your Hero between the Scenarios or when you repeat the Scenario with a different Hero, replace all of the previous Hero's Statistic cards and the Level I Specialty card with all of the Statistic cards and the Level I Specialty card of your new Hero. If the previous Hero had Empowered Statistics cards (p. 24), you can remove Statistic cards of the same type from the new Hero's Deck, and replace them with Empowered Statistic cards of the corresponding type. You can replace any card in the "5 other non-Specialty cards" group with new Hero's starting Ability card (if you don't already have a copy of that Ability) and Magic Arrow(s).° You cannot have more than 4 Magic Arrow° cards, even if the previous Hero had 5 of them.

TOURNAMENT MODE

The 1 vs. 1 Tournament Mode features rule changes to reduce randomness, allow more tactical decisions, and give players greater control.

Note: Tournament Mode is designed for the Core Game only. Rules for incorporating expansion content (e.g. Sea Map Tiles, p. 34) are not provided.

Changes during Setup

Before starting the game, do the following:

- Remove the Diplomacy° Ability card and the Hourglass of the Evil Hour° Artifact card from the game before building their respective Decks.
- Both players roll 2 ⚒. The player with the highest total chooses who starts.
- The second player gains 🦅 at the start of the game.

Building the Map

The Map in a Tournament Scenario is built by the players and is **completely revealed** at the start of the game. The Scenario's Map Layout only shows what the center of the Map should look like and which Tiles are needed to build the rest of the Map. The placement decisions of all other Map Tiles assigned to the Scenario are decided by both players.

Follow these rules to build the Map and **always place all Map Tiles face up**:

1. The starting player places the Map Tiles in the center of the map, matching them to the Scenario's Map Layout, and discovers and rotates them freely.
2. Starting with the second player, both players take turns adding the Scenario's Near Map Tiles to the Map, one at a time.
   - If possible, Near Map Tiles must be placed next to a Center Map Tile.
   - Every Scenario must have at least 2 Near Map Tiles with an Obelisk location on them.
   - The pool of available Near Map Tiles is facedown. Players draw a random Tile, reveal it, and choose how to place it.
3. Once all Near Map Tiles have been placed, the first player must place their Starting Map Tile adjacent to at least one Near Map Tile. The other player must place their Starting Map Tile on the opposite side of the Map – at the farthest position away from the first player's Starting Map Tile (counted in Tiles).
4. Starting with the first player, both players take turns adding the Scenario's Far Map Tiles to the Map, one at a time.
   - Every player's first Far Map Tile must be placed adjacent to their Starting Map Tile.
   - The remaining Map Tiles must follow the standard Tile Placement rules (p. 32).
   - The pool of available Far Map Tiles is facedown. Players draw a random Tile, reveal it, and choose how to place it.

Additional rules during the game

The following rules apply to every tournament Scenario:

- **Round One Mulligan:** On your Turn in the 1st Round, discard any number of cards from your hand, then draw up to your draw limit as normal. After you draw up to your draw limit, you may apply Mulligan: reshuffle your hand and your discard pile into your Deck. Then draw up to your draw limit again. You can use this Mulligan only once.
- All players can use Morale Tokens for a **new Morale Action**: During **any Search action**, discard all drawn cards and perform the Search action again.
- If you remove Artifact cards during the game, **keep them beside your Deck** until the end of the game, when these Artifact cards count toward your final Victory Points score.
- When visiting a **Redwood Observatory**, use its alternative effect (p. 79).
- **Optional rule**: You can play with the split Artifact and Spell Decks (p. 65) variant to have more control over the cards you draw.

Scoring Victory Points

When either the Scenario reaches its Round limit or any player completes the Scenario's victory condition, the game ends and both players count their Victory Points (VPs) according to the table below. The player with the most VPs wins the Scenario.

Victory Point scores

VPs	Category
1	for every controlled Mine or Settlement
1	for every building in your Town
1	for every two Artifact cards in your Deck (including removed ones)
1	for every Level of your Main Hero
2	for every enemy's Secondary Hero defeated
4	for defeating the enemy's Main Hero (only once)
X	for any additional objectives specified in a given Scenario's description

BATTLEFIELD

Overview

The Battlefield Expansion introduces the large Battlefield Board (p. 61) and two 1 vs. 1 game modes that focus on tactical combat on the Battlefield Board. Neither of these 2 modes uses the Map (p. 31). They differ in how players build their Unit and Player Decks:

- In **Adventure Mode**, players experience a card-driven Adventure Phase followed by a final Combat. The Adventure Phase replaces the Map exploration from regular games. During this phase, players use Adventure cards to gather Resources, expand their Town, and develop their Heroes, thereby deciding which units to recruit and which card types to include in their Deck.
- In **Skirmish Mode**, players receive pre-constructed Decks and armies, with minimal control over their composition. Players immediately engage in Combat.

You can also use the Battlefield Board instead of the Combat Board in other game modes.

Victory Condition

Victory in Adventure and Skirmish is achieved by defeating all enemy units in the final Combat.

Rule Ambiguity

Note: Both game modes were designed for the **Core Game only**. As a result, the official rules do not address many interactions, particularly those involving expansion content. Although these are not official rules, the game developers have provided guidance on these cases:

- The official rules remove only Diplomacy° and Logistics° Ability cards, but common sense applies: the developers also recommend removing other Ability cards which provide no benefit in Battlefield modes, like Ballistics° or Pathfinding.°
- In Skirmish Mode, when a card with no Combat value is drawn, both players may mutually agree to discard it and draw a replacement.
- All cards in the Adventure phase are single-use. Consequently, resource-generating Permanent ∞ cards (e.g., Inexhaustible Cart of Ore°) are limited to their bottom ↯ effect only. However, other Permanent ∞ cards (Schools of Magic and War Machines) can be used in the final Combat phase only.
- Card effects, which instruct you to remove other cards (e.g., Expert Scholar°), may be played during the Adventure phase, applying their effect to your Deck.
- When a card has both Combat and non-Combat effects (e.g., Cape of Velocity°), you decide whether to use it in the Adventure phase or reserve it for the final Combat.

Adventure and Skirmish Setup

Common Setup Steps C

1. Place the Battlefield Board in the middle of the table.
2. Each player chooses a Faction and a Hero of that Faction and takes the following components:
   a) Hero Board
   b) 3 Hero-specific Specialty cards and 1 Hero-specific Ability card
   c) 7 unit cards and 7 unit miniatures
   d) 20 Faction Cubes
3. Prepare the Artifact, Spell, and Ability Decks normally. Remove the following Ability cards from the play: Diplomacy,° Logistics.°
4. Prepare the Positive and Negative **Morale cards** (p. 19) (including all cards with the battlefield symbol).
5. Prepare the following Tokens near the Battlefield Board: Black Cubes, Damage Tokens, Defense/Paralysis Tokens, Obstacles, and the Initiative Token.
6. Prepare the Attack and Resource Dice.
7. Build your starting Deck as per steps 11–13 of Setup (p. 12).

Additional Steps for Adventure Mode A

8. Prepare Resource Tokens and Treasure Dice.
9. Each player takes a Town Board with the following starting setup:
   a) Set income tracks to 10 , 0 , and 0 .
   b) No Town Buildings or units in the Unit Deck.
10. Starting resources: 15 , 3 , and 1 .
11. Shuffle the Adventure Deck and place it face down.
12. Place the Round Tracker and put a Black Cube on Round 1.
13. Set Hero Level to I.
14. Set your starting Deck aside for now; you will only need it for the final Combat.

Start of the game

In both modes, both players roll 2 . The player with the highest total becomes the first player and takes the Initiative Token.

Adventure Mode

Adventure Mode is divided into two phases: the **Adventure Phase** and the **Final Combat**. The latter works identically to Skirmish Mode.
Before starting the game, both players choose a game length by setting the number of Rounds in the Adventure Phase:

- **Short** game: 9 Rounds.
- **Medium** game: 13 Rounds.
- **Large** game: 16 Rounds.

Adventure Phase

The Adventure Phase lasts a certain number of Rounds, depending on the chosen game length. Follow these steps in order during each Round.

1. **Move the Round Tracker** – skip this step in the first Round. Depending on the type of Round, resolve the following effects:
   - In **Resource Rounds** both players gain income normally.
   - In **Astrologers Rounds** – instead of drawing Astrologers Proclaim cards, players increase one of their income tracks (, , or) in one of the following ways:
     - ▷ Increase your preferred income track.
     - ▷ Determine it randomly by rolling a . If you do, gain the basic income of that resource immediately, which is 5 , 2 , or 1 .
2. **Determine starting player** – in odd-numbered Rounds, it's the player **with** the Initiative Token, in even-numbered Rounds, it's the player **without it**.
3. **Draw Adventure Cards** – skip this step in the last Round. The starting player draws 3 Adventure cards and takes one of them **into their hand**. Afterwards, they pass the remaining 2 to the other player, who takes 1 card into their hand and discards the other.
   Note: Before choosing the card, **the starting player** may use effects from set aside cards from your Deck (p. 59) to discard any number of the drawn Adventure cards and draw that many cards.
4. **Player Turns** – beginning with the starting player, both players take their turn by performing any of the following actions in any order:
   - **Resolve** (p. 59) an Adventure card from your hand. You may only resolve **one Adventure card per Round**.
   - Perform Town or Morale actions, or resolve your Hero's level ups (p. 21), in the same way as in regular games.
   - Use the effects of set aside cards from your Deck (p. 59), except for .

   At the end of the turn, **discard your hand down to 1 Adventure card**. If you still have a **Magic Spring** Adventure card in hand, **discard it**.

In the last Round, players do not draw Adventure cards, but they may still resolve an Adventure card from their hand. After the last Round, the Adventure Phase ends and the final Combat begins.

Starting the final Combat

Recover all spent . Pick up your Deck, shuffle it, and draw cards up to your Hero's Hand Limit. Remove all tokens from your units, take all your unit Miniatures, and begin the final Combat on the Battlefield Board following the Battlefield Combat rules (p. 61).

Resolving Adventure Cards

There are two types of Adventure cards: Combat and Event.

Adventure-Event card

1. Name
2. Type
3. Effect

Adventure-Combat card

4. Combat Power Levels
5. Battle Reward
6. Basic Reward

To resolve an **Adventure-Event card**, follow its printed effect. To resolve an **Adventure-Combat card**, follow these steps:

1. **Declare a Combat Power Level:** Choose one of the three available Combat Power Levels. You must reach at least that value to gain the full reward.
2. **Determine your Combat Power:** Select 2 of your units and roll 1 Attack Die for each. If you have fewer than 2 units, select as many as you have. Sum all unit Attack values and all Attack Die results to determine your final Combat Power.
3. **Get the Reward:** If your Combat Power is equal to or higher than your declared Combat Power Level, take both the Basic Reward and the Battle Reward. Otherwise, take only the Basic Reward and place a token on one of your units that took part in this Combat. This unit is now stunned. If you choose a stunned unit for a future Combat, do not add its Attack value to your Combat Power; then remove the token from that unit.

After resolving an Adventure card, place it in **your own** pile of resolved cards. For example, the Adventure-Event card "Obelisk" grows stronger with each Obelisk card you have played previously.

Managing Your Deck in Adventure Mode

Your Deck is not available during the Adventure Phase. Instead, the following rules apply:

- Place all cards of your starting Deck face down near your Hero Board. They will be used in the final Combat.
- Your limit applies to the entire Adventure Phase. Recover all spent at the start of the final Combat.
- Each time an effect instructs you to gain new cards (usually from leveling up or resolving Adventure cards), proceed as follows:
  - ▷ Cards that are **useful only in Combat** go directly into your Deck and remain there until the final Combat. You can't use these cards during Adventure Phase. Spells always go into your Deck, since their alternative effect (+1) is always useful in Combat.
  - ▷ Cards that **are not useful in Combat** because they provide Resources (e.g., Estates°) or , or provide discounts (e.g., Legs of Legion,° Wisdom°), are **set aside** next to your Hero Board. Each of these cards may be used **once, then removed** from the game. These cards do not go into your Deck.
  - ▷ If you are unsure how to categorize a card, note that clear rules do not exist for every individual case, and you may need to follow game developers' clarifications (p. 56), or agree on a house rule with your opponent.

Skirmish Mode

Skirmish Mode has no Adventure Phase. Skip that phase, prepare your Deck, and proceed directly to the final Combat.

Deck Preparation

Both players decide on a game length: **short, medium, or large**. Depending on the chosen game length, both players modify their Hero's Level, their Deck (by drawing additional cards), and their Unit Deck as shown in the table below.

	Short Game	Medium Game	Large Game
Hero Level	Level III	Level V	Level VII
Specialty cards	Level I Specialty card	Level I and Level IV Specialty cards	All Specialty cards
Ability cards	Draw 3 Ability cards and keep 2.	Draw 4 Ability cards and keep 3.	Draw 6 Ability cards and keep 4.
Artifact cards	Draw 2 Artifact cards and keep 1.	Draw 3 Artifact cards and keep 2.	Draw 4 Artifact cards and keep 3.
Spell cards	Draw 1 Spell card for a Hero or 2 Spell cards for a Hero.	Draw 2 Spell cards for a Hero or 4 Spell cards for a Hero.	Draw 3 Spell cards for a Hero or 5 Spell cards for a Hero.
Units	Use all and units on the "Few" side.	Use all and units on the "Pack" side.	Use all units (, , and) on the "Pack" side.

Starting the final Combat

After modifying your Deck, shuffle it and draw cards up to your Hand Limit. Then follow the rules for Combat on the Battlefield Board (p. 61).

Battlefield Combat

Playing on the Battlefield Board requires using Miniatures for Combat instead of unit cards.

Obstacle Tokens

You can place three token types on the Battlefield Board: Effect, Obstacle and Wall/Gate. Unless otherwise stated, these Tokens count and work as Combat Obstacles (p. 42). To place Effect Obstacles on the Battlefield Board you'll need the card that creates the effect, such as the Fire Wall° Spell: use the Tokens and put the card beside the Battlefield as a reminder. Effect Obstacles may be entered by units, if the card text allows it.

Effect *Obstacle* *Wall/Gate*

All unit Miniatures also count as Obstacles.

Combat Setup

Initiative Token

Starting with the player with the **Initiative Token** (the attacker in a non-Adventure/Skirmish game, p. 63), both players take turns choosing and placing Obstacle Tokens on the Battlefield Board one-by-one until **all Obstacle Tokens (except Effects) are placed**. No Obstacle can be adjacent to another Obstacle or to any player's deployment zone.

Obstacles and Miniatures placed correctly are marked with the green border, and incorrectly – with the red one.

The player with the Initiative Token chooses a deployment zone and places one of their units in it, then players take turns placing their units **one by one** each in their zone. The 5-unit limit does not apply in Adventure and Skirmish modes, and players may place all Faction units available to them. When the last unit is placed, the Combat begins.

Battlefield Combat Rules

Follow the regular Combat rules (p. 43) with the following changes:

- **Unit Movement** – Each unit's Movement is equal to its Initiative value: a unit of Initiative 8 can move up to 8 hexes.
- **Ranged Movement** – Ranged units can either move or attack, not both.
- **Combat Penalty** – Ranged units suffer a Combat Penalty when attacking an adjacent unit or a unit that is **8 or more** hexes away from them.
- **Initiative Tie** – If two or more opposing units have the same Initiative value, the player with the **Initiative Token** activates one of their units first. Then, the players alternate in activating all of their units of that same Initiative value one by one. Once all units with that Initiative value were activated, pass the Initiative Token to the other player, who keeps it until an Initiative tie of opposing units happens again.
- **In Adventure and Skirmish** (p. 56) **only** – At the end of each Combat Round, **regain one used** up to your Hero's Limit, and **draw 2 cards from your Deck**.

Battlefield Board in regular games

Although Battlefield is designed for Adventure and Skirmish modes (p. 56), it is possible to use the Battlefield Board in other game modes, though with minor rule modifications.

Changes to Combat Rules

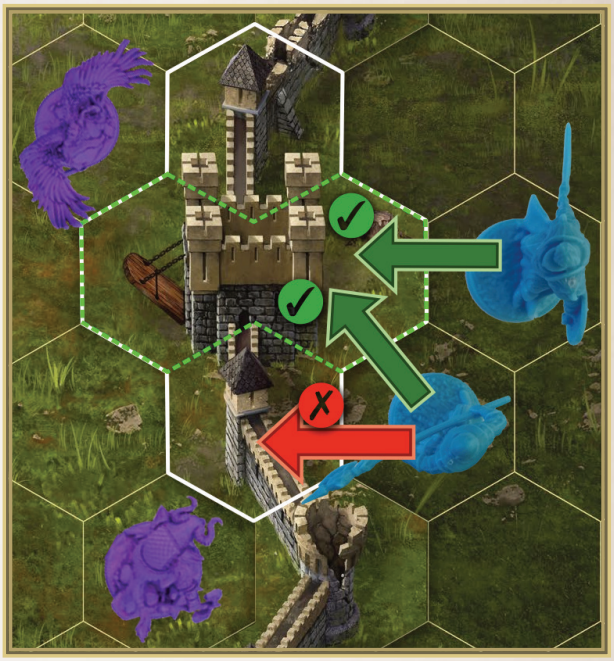
- The attacker receives the Initiative Token at the start of the Combat Setup.
- In player vs. player Combat, you may place up to 7 units. In Neutral Combat, the 5-unit limit still applies.
- Playing on the Battlefield Board requires using rules for Miniatures (p. 69).

Siege with Walls and Gate

During a Siege against a Town with a Citadel, Walls and Gate Obstacles are placed as shown below. Place no other Obstacles.

The red border marks incorrectly placed Obstacles.

During a Siege, defending units may enter the Gate Token **only through the two middle hexes** where the Gate is printed. Attacking the Gate Token is still possible on all four hexes.



Example: Halberdier and Crusader (defenders) may enter the Gate Token only along the green arrows, but Minotaur and Harpy are still able to attack the Gate Token from any side.

Combat with Neutral Units

If you decide to use the Battlefield Board in Combats with Neutral Units, ignore the Round Limit: at the end of each Combat Round you may freely decide to Retreat or to start another Combat Round with no need to spend . Be aware, however, that this may significantly extend the playtime. It is recommended to use the Battlefield Board only for **Player vs. Player Combats**.

RULE VARIANTS

You may modify the rules to increase or decrease difficulty, change how the game flows, or adjust its pacing. These are suggestions from the game developers.

Chaos Cards

Whenever you are about to discard a card, remove that card instead. Then, take the top card from the corresponding Deck and place it in your discard pile.

Note: Statistic and Specialty cards are still discarded normally.

Even if you use a Knowledge card° to return a Spell to your hand, the Spell is still removed, and you receive a new one from the top of the Spell Deck instead.

Neutral Army

When you use a Population token to **recruit** units, instead of **recruiting** them normally, for every Dwelling you have, draw 2 corresponding Neutral Unit cards. You can **recruit** any number of these units if you their costs. Discard all units that were not recruited.

Note: This variant is recommended only when there are no Heroes with unit-oriented Special Abilities in the game.

Draft Start

This rule allows you to modify your starting Deck by drafting its contents during the game's setup. After choosing your Heroes, instead of creating their normal starting Decks, follow the steps below.

For each chosen Hero, take their Starting Ability card from the Ability Deck and their Level I Specialty card, and set them aside.

Shuffle the Artifact, Ability, and Spell Decks separately. Each player draws the top 2 cards from each of these Decks and chooses one to keep. Then, each player passes the remaining 5 cards to the player on their left. Repeat this step until all of the cards have been taken. When that happens, the players – once again – draw the top 2 cards from the three Decks, choose one to keep, and pass the remaining 5 to the next player, but this time to the one on their right. Repeat the step until every player has a Deck totaling 12 cards drafted this way.

Now, based on the icons shown on their Hero Board, each player adds the corresponding Statistic cards to their Deck. At this point, a Might Hero's Deck should consist of 18 cards, and a Magic Hero's Deck of 17 cards.

Each player selects 7 cards from their Deck (discarding the rest) and adds them to the two cards they set aside at the beginning. Now, every player has their drafted Deck of 9 cards ready.

Note: This variant is recommended for 3+ players.

Split Artifact and Spell Decks

Note: Split Decks are often used in Tournament Mode (p. 54).

During Setup, split Artifact cards by their level (p. 27) into three separate Decks: Minor, Major and Relic. Afterwards, split the Spell Deck into two separate Decks for Basic and Expert Spells (p. 26). Discard the top card of each of the five Decks to form their Discard Pile.

Each time you gain an Artifact card or a Spell card **from visiting a Map Location**, perform a Search (X) action or draw a card from one of the available Decks depending on your Hero's position on the Map, according to the table below. If several Decks are available, choose one.

Deck availability

Hero's Position	Artifact Decks	Spell Decks
Tiles I, II–III	Minor	Basic
Tiles IV–V	Minor Major	Basic Expert
Tiles VI–VII	Minor Major Relic	Basic Expert

If you gain an Artifact or a Spell **outside of a Map Location** (e.g. by buying a Spell in a Mage Guild), **only your Main Hero's position** is relevant for choosing from the available Decks.

Gold Pool

This alternative rule for building and managing your army changes the dynamics of multiplayer clash games, improving the experience, particularly in games with an odd number of players. By mitigating the impact of casualties, it gives early combatants a fair chance against players with fresh armies and denies them an easy win.

Your pool of resources is now called the Unspent Pool. When you use the Population token to **recruit** or **reinforce**, instead of placing the and from your Unspent Pool back in the box, place the resources in a separate pile near your Unit Deck – this will be your Reserved Pool. The resources from the Reserved Pool cannot be used.

The next time you use your Population token to expand your army, you will be able to freely change your recruited units, meaning that you can not only buy new units, but also sell the ones you have. When you sell a unit or when it perishes, simply return its costs – both in and – from your Reserved Pool to your Unspent Pool. You can **recruit** and **reinforce** as many units as you can afford.

Whenever your unit is flipped from the "Pack" side to the "Few" side, you regain the cost.

Whenever you use a card that reduces a unit's **recruitment** or **reinforcement** costs, keep it with the unit's card to remind you how much and you will regain when the unit perishes or when it is sold (or when it is flipped to the "Few" side, if you used the card to pay the). When this happens, return the "discount card" to your hand.

Creature Banks

Playing with Creature Banks is an **optional rule**. If you decide to play with Creature Banks, the following rules apply.

Setup

Separate the Creature Bank Tokens into two piles (for Near and Far Map Tiles) based on the numerals on their backs. Shuffle each pile and place them near the Map. Place the Creature Bank unit cards face up near the Neutral Unit Decks. There is no need to shuffle these cards. Shuffle all Stack Tokens and place them face-down near the Creature Bank unit cards.

Creature Bank (Near)

Stack Token

Creature Bank unit card

Placing Creature Bank Tokens

When you discover a Near or Far Map Tile, you may choose to draw a Creature Bank Token of the corresponding type, and place it on the Tile's Blocked Field.

Visiting a Creature Bank Location

When you enter a Creature Bank Location, you must defeat the corresponding Creature Bank units defending it. If you win, resolve the Field's effect and mark it with a Black Cube. Because these Fields don't have any Difficulty Level, Quick Combat never happens, there is no Round limit, no need to spend MP to extend Combat, and you don't gain any ★. The defending units and all effects of all Creature Bank Locations are listed in All Map Locations (p. 84).

Combat in a Creature Bank

When you start Combat at a Creature Bank, place up to 5 of your units in the player deployment zone. Depending on the Creature Bank you are visiting, take the corresponding units from the Creature Bank unit cards and place them randomly in the Neutral unit deployment zone.

P – player deployment zone
N – Neutral Units deployment zone

Based on the Scenario's Difficulty Level, take a number of Stack Tokens (p. 67) and place them randomly on up to four different Creature Bank unit cards:

- **Easy**: 1 token
- **Normal**: 2 tokens
- **Hard**: 3 tokens
- **Impossible**: 4 tokens

NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

After Combat, return all Creature Bank units back to the Creature Bank units cards pile. If you win, you claim the Creature Bank's reward, as well as an additional reward for the Stacked units you defeated.

Creature Bank Units

Creature Bank Unit cards do not have a tier (★☆★★). As a result, any effects that depend on tiers (e.g., Berserk Spell°) do not apply to them. In addition, they follow special rules for AI targeting (p. 48).

Stack Tokens

Each Stack Token modifies a unit's statistic in the following way: +1 ⚔, +1 🛡, +1 ❤, or +2 🏃. Furthermore, each unit with a Stack Token is now a **Stacked unit**, which is similar to reinforced Faction units: when it takes damage equal to or greater than its ❤, instead of removing the unit card from the Combat Board, discard the Stack Token from that unit and deal any leftover damage, deducting it from the new ❤. Creature Bank units without a Stack Token are defeated normally.

Gained Stacked Units

Some rewards allow you to gain a Stacked Creature Bank unit card. Track which of your units are Stacked by whatever means is comfortable, e.g. by remembering it or by placing a Token or Cube on it. Whenever your Stacked unit goes to a Combat, draw a random Stack Token and place it on that unit. After Combat, note whether the unit is still Stacked (for future Combats), then return the Stack Token to the pile.

Alternative Combat Boards

NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

As an **optional rule**, you can use the **Naval Battle Board** for combats at sea locations. This Board removes the two middle spaces, requiring Ground 🐺 units to navigate around them while Flying 🪽 units can move over them but cannot end their movement there.

BATTLEFIELD EXPANSION

As an **optional rule**, you can use the **Battlefield Board** for combats between players in regular games. You can also use it for Neutral Combats, though this is not recommended. Refer to the Battlefield section (p. 61) for the rule changes regarding this Combat type.

Optional Rules Table

You may modify the rules to increase or decrease the game's difficulty.

Game Difficulty Levels	Change to the default rules
Increase	Towns do not produce resources when **flagged**, but players may use the buildings of a captured Town.
Increase	You may not reroll your dice.
Increase	All Treasure and Resource dice only give 1 resource.
Increase	No starting bonus.
Decrease	You start the game with a Secondary Hero.
Decrease	Every unit deals at least 1 during an attack.
Decrease	All Mines and Settlements provide double income.
Decrease	You may exchange your resources at any time, the Trading Post becomes **Visitable** and draws you 1 card from the Artifact Deck.
Decrease	Extending Combat no longer costs any MP.
Variant	The Attack Die no longer affects damage (but can still interact with abilities).
Variant	An Astrologers Proclaim card is also drawn at the start of the Resource Rounds.
Variant	Astrologers Proclaim cards are no longer drawn.
Variant	Black Cubes on all **Visitable** Fields are removed on 4th, 8th, and 12th Rounds.
Variant	The cards that would normally go to your hand now go immediately to your discard pile instead.

EXPANSION CONTENT

Numerous expansions have been released for Heroes III: The Board Game, introducing new gameplay elements. Most expansion rules are integrated directly into the relevant sections of this rulebook where they belong. Below you'll find an overview of all expansion content.

The following contents are added by many of the expansions:

Unit Miniatures

If you want to play your Combats with Miniatures, place and move them over the Combat Board instead of the cards. You can put Miniatures on top of the cards or keep the cards next to the Combat Board to form an initiative bar for better visualization of the order in which units activate.

If you play with Miniatures, there are a few rules to follow:

- If any of the following occur during Combat with Neutral Units, discard the Neutral Unit card and draw another card in its place:
  - ▷ if you draw the same Neutral Unit more than once,
  - ▷ if you draw any unit you already have in your army,
  - ▷ if you draw any unit from your Faction.
- While you recruit Neutral Units, you cannot recruit any units from a Faction that is controlled by a player or any units that are already in any player's army. Discard that unit card and draw another.

New Map Locations

Each expansion adds new Map Locations to the game, which your Heroes can explore. They are explained in All Map Locations (p. 73).

Permanent cards

Cards with a new type of effect which gives players permanent advantages, explained in Player Decks (p. 22).

Schools of Magic

Schools of Magic (p. 26) gain more significance with the expansions, as there are now card effects which use them, e.g. your Heroes can specialize in certain Schools to make their Spells more powerful.

Unique card effects with their own components

Several new cards from various expansions come with their own Token components and bring complex effects to the game. These are all explained in the separate section Card Effect Keywords (p. 86).

More of the same

In addition to new gameplay mechanics, expansions also expand the variety of existing components: new Factions, new Scenarios, new Spells, new Heroes, and new Artifacts.

Faction Expansions

Inferno Expansion

Contains the **Inferno Faction**: Demonic and fire-associated units under the command of Heretics and Demoniacs.
New gameplay mechanics: a new unit Ability to Summon Demons (p. 88) in combat; Empowered Statistic cards (p. 24) to make your Hero's Statistic cards more powerful, and the Random Town (p. 77) Map Location with unique combat rules.

Cove Expansion

Contains the **Cove Faction**: Pirate units and Sea monsters under the command of Captains and Navigators.
New gameplay mechanics: Sea Map Tiles (p. 34) with many new Sea Locations to discover; Whirlpools (p. 35) to travel quickly between distant Sea Tiles... but at a cost (p. 83); and the Cannon,° a new War Machine (p. 28).

Conflux Expansion

Contains the **Conflux Faction**: Magical Creatures of all elements under the command of Elementalists and Planeswalkers.
New gameplay mechanics: Elemental Map Tiles (p. 34) aligned with Schools of Magic; magical Monoliths (p. 35), which allow your Heroes to traverse long distances on the Map; a new type of damage (p. 42) which ignores Defense; and a unique Spell effect to Summon Elemental units (p. 88), which support you in combat.

Rampart Expansion

Contains the **Rampart Faction**: Nature-oriented units under the lead of Druids and Rangers.
New gameplay mechanics: Various War Machines (p. 28), which support you with permanent effects in combat.

Fortress Expansion

Contains the **Fortress Faction**: Poisonous swamp beasts under the command of Witches and Beastmasters.
New gameplay mechanics: the storytelling Event card (p. 15).

Stronghold Expansion

Contains the **Stronghold Faction**: Wild and orkish units under command of Barbarians and Battle Mages.
New gameplay mechanics: Subterranean Map Tiles (p. 34), which open a new world to explore, and mystical Spell Scrolls (p. 28), which allow your Heroes to cast additional Spells even if they are not as familiar with magic.

Tower Expansion

Contains the **Tower Faction**: Magic-oriented units under the lead of Wizards and Alchemists. This expansion doesn't introduce any new gameplay mechanics, but it expands many existing components, e.g. it adds more **Heroes of other Factions**.

Gameplay and Game Mode Expansions

Naval Battles Expansion

This expansion offers three new gameplay mechanics: The Naval Battle Board (p. 67) lets your Heroes fight Combat on ships, which is more challenging than on the normal Combat Board. The new Creature Banks (p. 66) Map Locations add challenging combats and Stacked units (p. 67). The Empowered Ability Tokens and Cards (p. 25) make your Hero more powerful.

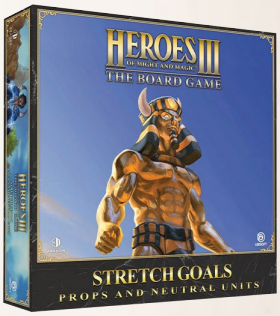
Battlefield Expansion

The heart of this expansion is a large Battlefield Board (p. 61). Two new game modes (p. 56) are added around the use of this Battlefield Board. Furthermore, the expansion offers an alternative Morale gameplay system (p. 19), which you can use instead of the Morale Tokens.

Stretch Goal Content

Four boxes of stretch goal content have been released for the board game. These expansions primarily contain aesthetic components, such as miniatures of Neutral Units, and Map Locations. They also expand the variety of existing components with additional Artifacts, Spells, and new Hero Boards for all Factions.

1st crowdfunding campaign:
Miniatures of the core game Faction Units



1st crowdfunding campaign:
Miniatures of Towns, Neutral Units, and other components

2nd crowdfunding campaign:
Miniatures

2nd crowdfunding campaign:
gameplay components and Miniatures

Town Cards

You can use Town Cards to randomly choose which player gets which Faction.

Here are some recommended options how to do that:

- Shuffle the Deck and deal 2 Town cards to each player. Each player then chooses their Faction from these cards. If you do not own enough Expansions, deal 1 card to each person instead.
- Shuffle the Deck and deal 2 Town cards to the first player. The first player chooses one card and passes the other one to the next player. The next player draws 1 more Town card from the Deck, selects one card from the two, and passes the other card to the next person. Repeat this until every player has chosen their Faction.

Skip the cards with Factions from Expansions which you don't have.

Alternative Manticores Card

A second **Manticores**° unit card with slightly different statistics is included in this expansion. When playing the Dungeon Faction, choose one of the two Manticores cards to use in the game.

Pandora's Box cards

Shuffle the Pandora's Box cards during setup. When visiting a Pandora's Box (p. 74), you may draw and resolve a Pandora's Box card instead of the location's regular effect. Mark the Map Field with a Black Cube regardless. Pandora's Box cards have their own discard pile.

Note: If you draw a Pandora's Box card with a Permanent ∞ effect while having a Permanent card (p. 22) already in play, discard your current card and put Pandora's card in its place.

ALL MAP LOCATIONS

Symbols on the Map

I-VII Field Difficulty corresponding to the Level of Neutral Units.

Roll a Treasure Die and gain the indicated bonus (⚒, 2⚒, ★, or ☥).

Roll a Resource Die (p. 29) and gain the indicated Resources.

2⚒ Roll 2 Resource Dice and choose the bonus from one of them.

★ Gain one Experience Point.

☥ Search (2) the Artifact Deck.

Search (2) the Spell Deck.

Gain Positive Morale.

Gain Negative Morale.

Gain 1 Movement Point for this turn.

? Special effect, see Settlements (p. 77), Revisitable (p. 78) or Other (p. 79) Fields.

+ 🪙/🪨/🔥 — Immediately gain the indicated Resource.

↻ 🪙/🪨/🔥 — Increase the production of the indicated Resource. If it is **flagged** for the first time, you also gain it immediately. See Mines (p. 76).

🪙/🪨/🔥 ➡ — The Player needs to pay the indicated Resource to gain something.

2 X — Perform the **X** action twice.

2 🎁/2 ⚒ ➡1 — Roll 2 Treasure or Resource Dice and resolve one, OR draw Pandora's Box card (p. 72).

> The effects of Fields are **always optional**. You must always place a Black Cube on Visitable Fields and a Faction Cube on Flaggable Fields even if you choose not to use that Field's effect.

The effects of the following **Visitable** fields are explained by the symbols on the left:

Artifact

Resource

Treasure

The effects of the following **Visitable** Fields are explained by the symbols on the previous page:

Fountain of Youth

Water Wheel

Warrior's Tomb

Temple

Mystical Garden

Learning Stone

Pandora's Box (land)

Pandora's Box (sea)

COVE EXPANSION

Shrine of Magic Gesture/Incantation

Windmill

Due to a misprint, the Windmill on the Tile `#N3` has a **?**. It should be "+1 ".

Flotsam

COVE EXPANSION

Sea Barrel

COVE EXPANSION

Mermaid

COVE EXPANSION

Buoy

COVE EXPANSION

Derelict Ship

COVE EXPANSION

Shipwreck

COVE EXPANSION

Temple of the Sea

COVE EXPANSION

Shipwreck Survivor

COVE EXPANSION

Shrine of Magic Gesture/Incantation

COVE EXPANSION

Towns

Towns are always located in the center of a Starting (I) Tile. Flagging an enemy Town prevents their Secondary Heroes from spawning there and Main Heroes from moving there if defeated. Flagging a Town can cause Player Elimination (p. 11), and Scenarios typically have special rewards for flagging them. Flagging a Town also gives you a **Faction Cube** from its previous owner. Otherwise, flagging a Town does not affect its original owner in any way. They do not lose access to their Town Board or its functions. You also do not gain access to their Town Board or Faction units, unlike in the video game.

Towns from the core game:
Necropolis, Castle, and Dungeon.

Mines

Mines are flaggable Fields which increase a specific resource's income when flagged. If you are the first one to flag a mine, it also immediately provides you with its income. All mines have the ↻ symbol and a picture of the Resource they produce next to it.

A mine that produces ◆, guarded by Level III Neutral Units. The first player to flag this Field would immediately gain one ◆ in addition to increasing their ◆ income.

Various ◆ mines.

● and ● mines.

Towns from expansions:
Conflux, Stronghold, Cove, Tower, Rampart, Fortress, and Inferno.

Settlements act as a spawn point for Secondary Heroes, and as a place for Main Heroes to move to when defeated. They also prevent Player Elimination (p. 11). When you flag a Settlement, choose one of the following options:

- Increase your , , or income by one space. As with Mines, if you are the first player to flag a Settlement, you **immediately** gain Resources equal to that increase in production. Mark the Settlement with an appropriate Resource Token to show which Resource it produces. When you flag an enemy Settlement, you may change this Resource. If your Settlement is lost, decrease its production.
- **Or reinforce** one of your or units immediately for half the normal cost, rounded up. If you were the first player to flag the Settlement, reinforce that unit **for free** instead. Do not place any Resource Tokens on the Settlement if you choose to reinforce.

Note: all Settlements work identically.

Settlements from the core game.

INFERNO EXPANSION
STRETCH GOALS 2 EXPANSION

Random Town

When revealed, choose a Faction not in play. Either:

- All players roll 2 . The highest roller chooses, OR

STRETCH GOALS 2 EXPANSION

- Draw a random Town Card (p. 72).

The Random Town is defended by units from that Faction:

- a "Pack" of units, chosen by the player who controls the defense during this Combat,
- two "Packs" of units,
- two "Fews" of units.

Add Walls and the Gate (p. 46) for this Combat, but not the Arrow Tower. Flagging the Random Town increases production by 10, which is also gained immediately if you are the first to flag it. While you have the Random Town flagged, treat it as a Settlement.

Note: Tiles with the Random Town can be used only if there is at least one unused Faction in the game.

Settlements from expansions.
Each is styled after a different Faction.

Revisitable Fields

Stables

Category: **Revisitable**
Gain 1 . It lasts for only one Turn. See Movement Actions (p. 17).

Sanctuary

Category: **Revisitable**
Heroes on this Field cannot be attacked by other Heroes. Friendly Heroes can move through enemy Heroes on this Field but cannot stop here.

Trading Post

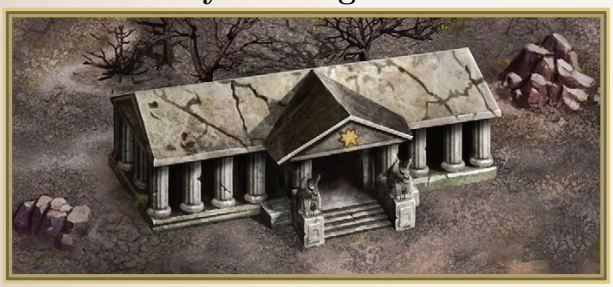
Category: **Revisitable**
Choose one trade (p. 52) **option:** trade resources (p. 92) OR remove one card and gain 1 OR buy a War Machine (p. 28) at a higher cost OR sell a Spell Scroll (p. 28).

War Machine Factory

RAMPART EXPANSION

Category: **Revisitable**
Buy a War Machine (p. 28) at a lower cost.

Library of Enlightenment



TOWER EXPANSION

Category: **Revisitable**
You may 3 to remove 1 Statistic card from your hand or Discard Pile and replace it with any other Statistic card. You may do this twice per visit.

Black Market

TOWER EXPANSION

Category: **Revisitable**
Look at the top 4 cards from the Artifact Discard Pile. You may buy one of them for:

- 5 if it is a **Minor** Artifact
- 7 if it is a **Major** Artifact
- 10 if it is a **Relic** Artifact

Tavern

TOWER EXPANSION

Category: **Revisitable**
You can 7 to gain a Secondary Hero. Place their model on this Field. Then, choose one enemy player to discard 1 random card from their hand.

Other Fields

Obelisk

Category: **Flaggable**
The Obelisk's effects depend on the Scenario. When you flag this Field, do not remove any enemy Faction Cubes; multiple players may have a Faction Cube on this Field.

Tree of Knowledge

Category: **Visitable**
You may 3 or 10 to gain 2 .

Grail

Category: **Visitable**
Gain a Grail Token. Only one Grail Token can exist in the game, do not gain another if this Field's Black Cube is removed or if there are multiple Grail Fields. The Token's effects are described in the Scenario's description.

Redwood Observatory

Category: **Visitable**
Discover a Tile adjacent to this one, either a face down one, or a new one (p. 32) from your supply.
Tournament Mode (p. 54): Rotate an adjacent Tile not occupied by a Hero, but follow the standard rules (p. 32) for placing Tiles.

Magic Spring

Category: **Visitable**
You may look at the top 3 cards of your Discard Pile and return one of them to your Hand. Return the remaining cards to the top of your Discard Pile in any order.

Witch Hut

Category: **Visitable**
Choose one: Remove an Ability card from your hand OR look at the top card of the Ability Deck and put that card into your hand or into the Ability Deck Discard Pile.

Dragon Utopia

Category: **Flaggable**
Effects depend on the Scenario.

Faerie Ring

CONFLUX EXPANSION

Category: **Visitable**
Remove one card from your hand, then **Search (2)** the card's Deck. You cannot remove Statistics, Starting Ability, or Specialty cards.

Scholar

FORTRESS EXPANSION

Category: **Visitable**
Roll 1 Attack Die. Depending on the result, do the following:

- **+1** – Gain a Statistic card of your choice or remove a Statistic card from your hand.
- **0** – Draw 2 cards from the Ability Deck, gain one of them and discard the other.
- **−1** – Draw 2 cards from the Spell Deck, gain one of them and discard the other.

Elemental Conflux

CONFLUX EXPANSION

Category: **Visitable**
For every Dwelling you have, draw from the corresponding Neutral Unit Decks until you find one "Elementals" unit from each (reshuffle if you run out of units before finding one). You can recruit one of those Elementals if you its recruitment cost. Shuffle the remaining units back into their respective Decks.

University

TOWER EXPANSION

Category: **Visitable**

6 to **Search (4)** the Ability Discard Pile.

Market of Time

TOWER EXPANSION

Category: **Visitable**

Remove one card from your hand. Then **Search (2)** the Ability, Spell, or Artifact Deck.

Hill Fort

TOWER EXPANSION

Category: **Visitable**

You may immediately reinforce one of your ★ or ☆ units. The reinforcement cost is reduced by 3 to a minimum of 0.

Prison

TOWER EXPANSION

Category: **Visitable**

Gain a Secondary Hero. Place their model on this Field. If you already have a Secondary Hero, gain 3 instead.

Spell Scroll

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

Category: **Visitable**

Take a Spell Scroll card from its Deck and place it next to your Hero Board. Draw two Spells and place them face-down at the Spell Scroll card. You can use these Spells with some restrictions (p. 28).

Cyclops Stockpile

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

Category: **Visitable**

When preparing the Neutral Army guarding this location, instead of drawing 1 ★ unit, find 2 ★ Cyclopes° and add them to the Neutral Army (look for them first in the ★ discard pile, and then in the ★ Neutral Unit Deck). If you win the Combat, roll and resolve 4 ⚒. Any additional effects depend on the Scenario.

Sea Chest

COVE EXPANSION

Category: **Visitable**
Roll 1 Attack Die. Depending on the result, do the following:

+1 – Search (1).
0 – Gain 5.
−1 – Gain nothing.

Jetsam

COVE EXPANSION

Category: **Visitable**
Roll 1 Attack Die. Depending on the result, do the following:

+1 – Roll and resolve 2.
0 – Roll and resolve 1.
−1 – Gain nothing.

Star Axis

INFERNO EXPANSION

Category: **Flaggable**
You may remove one of your Statistic cards from your hand and replace it with an **Empowered** (p. 24) one of the same type. When you flag this Field, do not remove any enemy Faction Cubes; multiple players may have a Faction Cube on this Field.

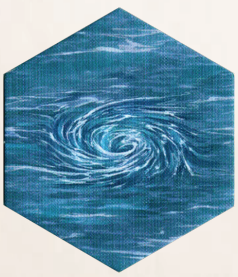
Grave

COVE EXPANSION

Category: **Visitable**
Gain , 3 , and **Search (1)** .

Location Tokens

The following Fields are found only on Location Tokens from various Expansions, not on regular Map Tiles. The placement of the Location Tokens is described in Map Elements (p. 35).



Note: For the following Fields, skip the movement if you would be stepping onto an allied Hero and do not have enough MP to move off it immediately. If the Field's effect placed your Hero on a Token on a still face-down Tile, discover that Tile.

One-Way Entrance Monolith

CONFLUX EXPANSION

Category: **Revisitable**

Move your Hero to the corresponding Exit Monolith (see below).

Two-Way Monolith

CONFLUX EXPANSION

Category: **Revisitable**

Move your Hero to the corresponding Two-Way Monolith.

One-Way Exit Monolith

CONFLUX EXPANSION

Category: **Revisitable**

Treat it as an empty Field.

Subterranean Gate

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

Category: **Revisitable**

Connects a surface and a Subterranean Map Tile (p. 34). Treat both sides of the Gate as a single Field.

Whirlpool

COVE EXPANSION

Category: **Revisitable**

Move your Hero to another Whirlpool Token. If there are 3 Whirlpools, roll an Attack Die to determine where your Hero goes, and reroll any Die that shows the number of the Whirlpool your Hero is moving from. After each Whirlpool travel, lose 1 unit from your unit Deck.

Creature Bank

NAVAL BATTLES EXPANSION

Category: **Visitable**

Start a Creature Bank Combat (p. 66) against the specified units (see the list on the next page). If you win, receive the reward and a bonus depending on the number of Stacked units. Creature Banks count as **land Fields** (even if designed as sea locations) and are NOT treated as other Fields of the same name.

Creature Banks on Far Map Tiles (II–III)

Creature Bank	Units	Reward	Extra reward for X Stacked units
Imp Cache	4 × Familiars°	3	X
Crypt	1 × Skeletons° 1 × Zombies° 1 × Wraiths° 1 × Vampires°	6	2 × X
Dwarven Treasury	4 × Dwarves°	7	3 × X
Medusa Stores	4 × Medusas°	6, 1	3 × X, X
Dragon Fly Hive	4 × Dragon Flies°	1 × Dragon Flies	Dragon Flies are Stacked, if there were at least 2 Stacked units.
Shipwreck	4 × Wraiths°	and 5	2 × X and Search (X) the Artifact Deck.

Creature Banks on Near Map Tiles (IV–V)

Creature Bank	Units	Reward	Extra reward for X Stacked units
Derelict Ship	4 × Water Elementals°	and 7	2 × X and Search (X) the Spell Deck.
Pyramid	2 × Gold Golems° 2 × Diamond Golems°	Search (5) the Spell Deck.	Up to X times: Remove 1 Spell, Ability, or Artifact card from your or Discard Pile, then Search (5) the appropriate Deck
Griffin Conservatory	4 × Griffins°	1 × Griffins	Griffins are Stacked, if there were at least 2 Stacked units.
Naga Bank	4 × Nagas°	6 , 2	6 × X , X
Cyclops Stockpile	4 × Cyclopes°	8 , 2	2 × X , X
Dragon Utopia	1 × Black Dragons° 1 × Gold Dragons° 1 × Faerie Dragons° 1 × Crystal Dragons°	40 and Search (3) the Artifact Deck.	X times: Search (5) the Artifact or Spell Deck.

CARD EFFECT KEYWORDS

Most expansions add new cards to the game. Some of these cards use keywords with more elaborate rules and require specific game components. This section provides the rules for these keywords.

Spell Card Keywords

Some Spell cards allow you to place **Effects** or **Summoned Units** on the Combat Board. Use the corresponding Tokens to mark these spaces.

COVE EXPANSION

Clone Token

When you cast the **Clone Spell**,° choose an allied unit (depending on the used) and an adjacent empty space on the Combat Board. Place the small Clone Token on the chosen unit and the larger Token of the same color (blue or red) on the empty space. The larger Token on the empty space represents the Clone. The Clone functions identically to the original unit, copying everything printed on its card, but excluding any other effects played on the original unit. If the Clone takes at least 1 from any source, or is attacked (even if that attack inflicts 0), inflict enough damage to set its to 0. A Clone is removed from the Combat Board if its original unit is removed from the Combat Board.

Clone Tokens

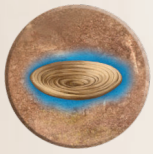
Clone Example

One of Bob's units in Combat is "Few" Griffins with an Initiative value of 6. He casts the Clone Spell on them, placing the small Clone Token on the Griffins and the larger Token of the same color on an adjacent empty space. Later, he casts "Haste" with 0 on the original Griffins, increasing their Initiative by 1. The original Griffins' Initiative value is now 7, but the Clone's Initiative remains 6.

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

Quicksand Token

While casting the **Quicksand Spell**,° depending on the used, take 2, 4 or 6 **Quicksand Tokens** from the same set (blue or red). Half of them must be "empty" and half must have the Quicksand symbol. Shuffle the Tokens face down and place one on each chosen empty space on the Combat Board. If there are not enough empty spaces to place all of them, discard any leftover Tokens. Once placed, you may look at your Tokens at any time. When a unit enters a space with a Quicksand Token, reveal it. If it is empty, the unit continues its movement. If the Token shows the Quicksand icon, the unit's movement and activation end immediately.
Note: Two Quicksand Tokens may occupy a single space only if they are placed by different players.



Quicksand Token

Empty Quicksand Token

BATTLEFIELD EXPANSION
CONFLUX EXPANSION

Fire Wall Token

The **Fire Wall Spell**° and **Luna's Specialty cards I and VI**° instruct you to place the Fire Wall card onto a space on the Combat Board. You may use the Fire Wall Tokens instead of the cards. Place the Spell or Specialty card next to the Combat Board as a reminder. When the card is removed or discarded, discard the Token as well. When using the large Battlefield Board (p. 61), you must use the Token instead of the card.

Fire Wall Token (Spell)

Fire Wall Token (Luna's Specialty)

STRETCH GOALS 2 EXPANSION

Land Mine Token

While casting the **Land Mine Spell**,° depending on the used, take 2, 4 or 6 **Land Mine Tokens**. Half of them must be "empty" and half must have a 2 symbol. Shuffle the Tokens face down and place one on each chosen empty space on the Combat Board. If there are not enough empty spaces to place all of them, discard any leftover Tokens. Once placed, you may look at your Tokens at any time. When a unit enters a space with a Land Mine Token, reveal that Token. If it is empty, the unit continues its movement. If the Token shows the 2 symbol, the unit takes 2 damage. If the unit is still on the Board, it continues its activation.
Note: Two Land Mine Tokens may occupy a single space only if they are placed by different players.

Land Mine Token (Backside)

Empty Land Mine Token

Land Mine Token

Force Field Token

Use the **Force Field Token** to mark the effect of the **Force Field Spell**.° The Token represents an Obstacle, so only units can move through a space with this Token. If you're using the normal Combat Board, place 1 Force Field Token. If you're using the Battlefield Board (p. 61), place 2 Tokens on two adjacent spaces.

Force Field Token

INFERNO EXPANSION
CONFLUX EXPANSION

Summoned units activate in the Round they were summoned if their Initiative is lower than or equal to the Initiative of the currently activated unit. Otherwise, treat them as if they already activated this Combat Round.

CONFLUX EXPANSION

Summon Elemental Units

The **Summon Elemental Spells** allow you to add an Elemental unit to the Combat Board during Combat. Keep the Summoned Unit Deck face up near the Neutral Unit Decks. Depending on the used, you can Summon either a non-reinforced unit (a Few) or a reinforced one (a Pack). Take the corresponding unit card from the Summoned Unit Deck and place it on a chosen empty space. You may place **Summon Unit Tokens** instead of the cards. When using the Battlefield Board (p. 61), you must place the Token. Summoned units remain under your control until they perish or Combat ends. A Summoned Elemental Unit is **not** added to your Unit Deck.

A Few Air Elementals

A Pack of Air Elementals

Fire Elemental Token

Water Elemental Token

Earth Elemental Token

Air Elemental Token

INFERNO EXPANSION

Summon Demons

A **"Pack" of Pit Lords**° unit from the Inferno Faction may use their ability to summon or reinforce the Demons° unit during Combat. This effect cannot summon Demons from the Neutral Unit Deck. Place the summoned "Few" Demons adjacent to the Pit Lords. If "Few" Demons are already in Combat, reinforce them instead. After Combat, unless stated otherwise, the summoned Demons **are** added to your Unit Deck.

Pit Lords

Demons

Tokens on Units

The following components and keywords are used by certain unit abilities. These Tokens are typically placed on other units to modify their statistics.

COVE EXPANSION
STRETCH GOALS 2 EXPANSION

Weakness Token

Weakness Token

When an effect places a Weakness Token on a unit, it specifies which side to use: −1 or −2. A unit with this Token suffers −1 ⚔ or −2 ⚔, as indicated by the Token's side. Each unit can have only one Weakness Token at a time. If a unit would gain a second one, the player controlling it chooses which one to keep. *For example, this Token can be given to units by the Sorceresses° unit's ability.*

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION
STRETCH GOALS 2 EXPANSION

Attack Token

Attack Token

When an effect places an Attack Token on a unit, it specifies which side to use: 1 or 2. Units with such a Token gain an additional 1 ⚔ or 2 ⚔, as indicated by the Token's side. Each unit can have only one Attack Token at a time. If a unit would gain a second one, the player controlling it chooses which one to keep. *For example, this Token can be given to units by the Ogres° unit's ability.*

STRONGHOLD EXPANSION

Corrosion Token

Corrosion Token

The Corrosion Token reduces the unit's 🛡 by 1 to a minimum of 0. A unit can have only one Corrosion Token at a time. If a unit would gain a second Corrosion Token, discard one of them. Unless removed by Spells or other effects, a Corrosion Token remains on the unit until the end of Combat. *For example, this Token is given to enemy units by the Behemoths° unit's ability.*

Fan-Made Wiki

Many cards in **Heroes of Might and Magic 3: The Board Game** have ambiguous or misleading wording. Fortunately, the developers have clarified many card effects.

The Community maintains a **Fan-Made Wiki**: a collection of nearly all game components with extensive notes to clarify specific rules. If you have questions about specific cards, visit this website: https://en.homm3bg.wiki/

CREDITS

Original 1.0 author: Hermanni Karppela

Authors of updates: Johannes Wolff, Andrzej Wiącek, Alexey Sokolov

GitHub engineering: Andrzej Wiącek, Alexey Sokolov, Vadász András, Tomáš Zeman

LaTeX writing: Andrzej Wiącek, Alexey Sokolov, Johannes Wolff, Vadász András

Graphics editing: Andrzej Wiącek, Alexey Sokolov, Vadász András

Layout design: Kate Katrankova, Andrzej Wiącek, Alexey Sokolov

Proofreading: Rickard Nilsson, Leena Häkkinen, Dániel Kovács, Joris de Kleer

Internationalization: Victor Marchuk, Andrzej Wiącek, Alexey Sokolov

Special thanks: Everyone from Archon Studio, for producing the game and answering our incessant queries about rules and other topics. Jon Van Caneghem and everyone involved with the development of the original video game. Everyone who has supported the project with suggestions, corrections, image resources and words of encouragement either on Discord or BoardGameGeek.

Cover art: Iana Vengerova

Artwork borrowed from official release was made by: Iana Vengerova, Tomasz Badalski, Yoann Boissonnet, János Brumár, Shen Fei, Marcin Jarkiewicz, Dave Ketch, Krzysztof Porchowski Jr., Tomasz Tworek, Viviane Tybusch Souza, Bartosz Winkler

INDEX

A

Ability cards 24
Activation
  Combat 43
  Effects 22, 37
  Unit 37
Adventure mode 56
AI card 50
Arrow Tower 46, 48
Artifact cards 27
Astrologers Proclaim cards 15
Attack
  Hero 21
  Unit 37, 45
Attack Die 42, 45
Attack Token 89

B

Basic Effect 24
Basic Spell 26
Battlefield 56
Build Token 18, 30
Buildings 30

C

Campaign 53
Citadel 30, 36, 41, 46, 63
City Hall 30
Clone 86
Combat 40, 48, 61
Combat cards (Adventure) 59
Combat Obstacles 42, 61
Combat Penalty 38
Combat Power (Adventure) 59
Corrosion Token 89
Creature Banks 35, 66, 84

D

Damage 43, 45
Deck of Might & Magic 13
Defend Action 42
Defense
  Hero 21
  Unit 37, 45
Dice 29, 42, 73
Discard Pile 11, 22
Discovering Tiles 32
Dwellings 30

E

Elemental Damage 42
Elemental Map Tile 34
Empowered Ability 25
Empowered Ability cards 24
Empowered Statistic cards 24
Empowering Spells 26
Empty Field 31
Event cards 15
Event cards (Adventure) 59
Experience 20, 44
Expert Effect 24
Expert Spell 26

F

Few 37, 39
Fire Wall 87
Flying Units 38, 48
Force Field 87

G

Ground Units 38, 48

H

Hand Limit 17
Hero Board/Card 21
Hero Specialty card 27
Hit Points (HP) 37, 45

I

Initiative 37, 41
Initiative Token 61
Instant Effects 22

K

Knowledge 21

L

Land Mine 87
Level 21

M

Mage Guild 30
Main Hero 20, 44
Map Effects 22, 37
Map Tile 31
Mines 76
Miniatures 69
Monolith 35, 83
Morale 19
Movement Actions 17

N

Naval Battle 67
Necropolis card 24
Negative Morale 19
Neutral Units 38

O

Obstacles, Combat 42, 61
Ongoing Effects 22, 43

P

Pack 37, 39
Pandora's Box cards 72
Paralysis 42
Permanent cards 22
Population Token 18, 36
Positive Morale 19
Power 21

Q

Quick Combat 40
Quicksand 87

R

Random Town 77
Ranged Units 38, 48
Recruiting 36
Reinforcing 36
Resource Die 29
Resources 29
Retaliation Attack 42, 45
Retreat 43

S

Schools of Magic 26
Sea Map Tile 34
Search (X) 22, 23
Secondary Hero 20, 44
Settlement 77
Siege Combat 46, 48, 63
Skirmish mode 56
Solo Mode 10, 53
Special Unit Ability 37, 88, 89
Specialty cards 27
Spell Book Token 18
Spell cards 26, 51, 86
Spell Scroll cards 28
Split Decks 65
Stacked Units 67
Starting Bonus 10
Starting Units 36
Statistic cards 24
Subterranean Gate 35, 83
Subterranean Map Tile 34
Summoning 88
Surrender 44

T

Time Limit 43
Time Token 22
Timed Events 15
Tournament mode 54
Town 30, 76
Town Actions 18
Town cards 72
Trading 52
Treasure Die 73

U

Unit Dwellings 30, 36
Units 36
Units Placement 41, 61

V

Victory Conditions 11
Victory Points 55

W

Walls and Gate 46, 48, 63
War Machine cards 28
Weakness Token 89
Whirlpool 35, 83

Field Difficulty Level Table

	Easy	Normal	Hard	Impossible
Level I	★	★	★★	★★★
Level II	★★	★★	★★★	★★☆
Level III	★☆	★★☆	★☆☆	☆☆☆
Level IV	★★☆	★☆☆	☆☆☆	☆☆★
Level V	★★☆★	★☆☆★	☆☆★★	☆★★★
Level VI	★★☆☆★	★☆☆★★	☆☆★★★	☆★★★★
Level VII	★	★★	★★★	★★★★

Trade Table

Sells/gets	...to purchase	...to purchase	...to purchase
I am selling ...	–	6 → 1	2 → 1
I am selling ...	1 → 3	–	1 → 2
I am selling ...	1 → 1	3 → 1	–